

Keka, end to end

Everything Keka sells, what it costs, which tier each feature sits in, how a tenant is structured, how you log in, and what it actually takes to get from signing the contract to running your first payroll. Every claim carries its evidence grade.

Compiled 18 September 2026 Vendor Keka Technologies Pvt Ltd, Hyderabad Site [keka.com](#)

Sections 23 Primary sources 900+ URLs

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Diagrams in this report are original schematics drawn from documented behaviour, not screen captures. Part 22 indexes Keka's own help-centre articles that contain real product screenshots.

PART 01

How to read this

This is assembled from Keka's own admin help centre and developer docs, its marketing and legal pages, its live status page, and independent third-party sources. Nothing here is invented, and where something could not be confirmed it says so rather than filling the gap.

Evidence grades

Every substantive claim below is tagged. The tag tells you how hard the fact is, which matters more than usual here because Keka's own pages contradict each other in several places and a large share of the "Keka review" content on the open web is published by direct competitors.

- KEKA DOCS** Stated in Keka's help centre, developer docs or legal agreements. Hardest evidence.
- KEKA CLAIM** Keka's own marketing or product pages. Real, sometimes aspirational.
- THIRD PARTY** Independent source — review platforms, registries, business press.
- UNVERIFIED** Single-source, competitor-published, internally inconsistent, or not found at all.

ON SCREENSHOTS

This report contains **original architecture and screen diagrams, not captured screenshots**. Keka's application sits behind a per-customer login, and this session had no browser able to reach it. Rather than pass off drawings as screen captures, the diagrams here are clearly labelled schematics that show structure and data flow, and Part 22 is a linked index of roughly 120 Keka help-centre articles that *do* contain real product screenshots — organised by screen, so you can open the exact article for any screen described here.

ON PRICES

Keka renders its pricing page with JavaScript and publishes no amounts in the page source. **Every rupee and dollar figure in Part 03 is third-party sourced**, corroborated across multiple independent listings and cross-checked by arithmetic. Treat them as a well-supported estimate to negotiate against, not as a quote. A stale 2024 price list (₹6,999 / ₹9,999 / ₹13,999) is still circulating on several aggregators — do not use it.

Three naming corrections worth making up front

- **The HR & Payroll tiers are Foundation → Strength → Growth**. Not "Essential / Growth / Scale" — that is greytHR's naming. **THIRD PARTY**
- **Basic / Advance / Scale** are the *PSA* tiers; **Pro / Advanced** are the *Keka Hire* tiers. Mixing these up is the most common error in third-party write-ups. **KEKA DOCS**

- There is **no product called "Keka Global."** Keka runs three payroll geographies — India, United States, and UAE/GCC — each as a distinct localisation. **UNVERIFIED**

PART 02

What Keka actually is

A cloud HR and payroll suite built for the Indian mid-market, sold as one subscription with two bolt-on products. Keka positions the whole thing as "PeopleOS", organised into four suites.

INCORPORATED 2014 21 July 2014, Hyderabad (MCA registry, CIN U72500TG2014PTC094953)	FOUNDER & CEO V. Yalamanchili Vijay Yalamanchili	FY25 REVENUE ₹133.86 Cr up 55% on FY24's ₹78 Cr	FUNDING \$58.6M \$57M WestBridge Series A, Nov 2022; nothing since
HEADCOUNT ~950–1,300 946 per registry (Jan 2026); ~1,275 per Inc42	G2 RATING 4.4 / 5 2,391 reviews; 74% mid-market		

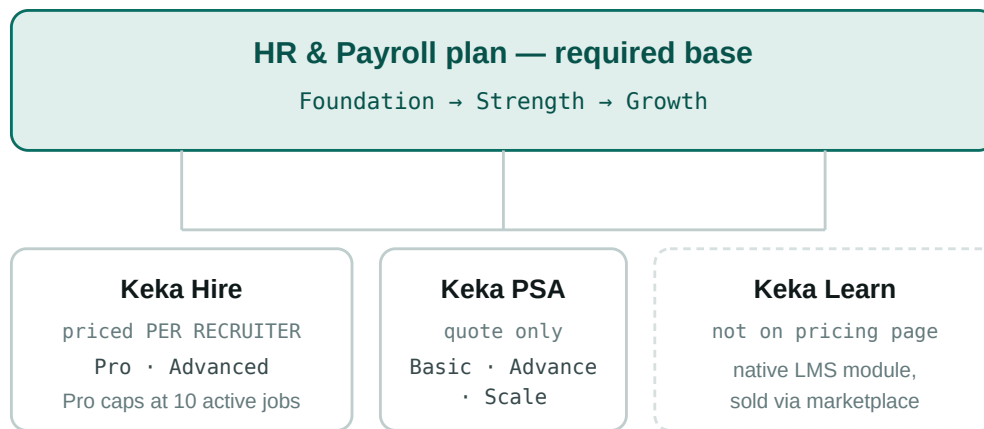
The four suites

Payroll Suite The commercial anchor. Six-step payroll run, full Indian statutory stack, expenses and travel, loans, payroll analytics, accounting journal export. KEKA CLAIM	HR Suite HRIS and org structure, onboarding and exits, documents and letters, assets, helpdesk, workforce management, time & attendance, leave. KEKA CLAIM
Talent Suite Keka Hire (ATS), performance reviews and calibration, OKRs and goals, engagement and pulse, rewards, skills and career paths, Keka Learn (LMS). KEKA CLAIM	Project Services (PSA) Clients and projects, timesheets, resource planning and utilisation, rate cards and margin, billing and invoicing, 46 named reports. KEKA CLAIM

How the commercial blocks fit together

This is the structural fact that shapes every quote you will get. Keka sells **four separate things**, and two of them cannot be bought on their own.

KEKA DOCS



Neither Hire nor PSA can be bought standalone — both require an HR & Payroll plan first.

Schematic — commercial structure. Keka's packaging, drawn from its pricing page and help centre. The dashed box marks a module that exists and is documented but is absent from the published tier matrix.

WHERE IT PLAYS

Gartner categorises Keka under *Cloud HCM Suites for Regional and/or Sub-1,000 Employee Enterprises* — the most objective statement of its segment available. G2's reviewer base is **74% mid-market (51–1,000 employees)**, ~20% small business, ~10% enterprise. **THIRD PARTY**

Named customers and case studies

Logos on keka.com include eBay, OnePlus, Randstad, Grant Thornton, BYD, Plum, Yulu, Astrotalk, ClearTax, Jupiter, Xoxoday, Ketto, Awfis, Noise and Mouritech. **KEKA CLAIM**

Published case studies with numbers: **WorkIndia** (704 employees, decision-to-implementation 30 days), **Mouritech** (900+ employees across five continents), **Awfis** (5× headcount growth since 2015), **Ketto** (time-to-hire improved 70%).

TWO OF KEKA'S OWN NUMBERS DISAGREE

The homepage says **12,500+ companies**; the About page says **10,000+**. The About page also says "founded in 2016" with Bengaluru as HQ, which contradicts the MCA registry (incorporated 2014, Hyderabad) and Keka's own machine-readable company page. **Use 2014 / Hyderabad**. Neither customer count has any independent verification.

UNVERIFIED

PART 03

Pricing and packaging

Keka's India model is a flat base fee covering the first 100 employees plus a per-head rate above that. This shape is the single most important commercial fact about the product: it makes Keka expensive for small teams and competitive from 100 employees up.

India — current list (ex-tax)

PLAN	BASE / MONTH (UP TO 100 EMPLOYEES)	EACH ADDITIONAL EMPLOYEE / MONTH	P
Foundation	₹9,999	₹90	"a
Strength	₹12,999	₹120	"e
Growth	₹15,999	₹150	"t

THIRD PARTY

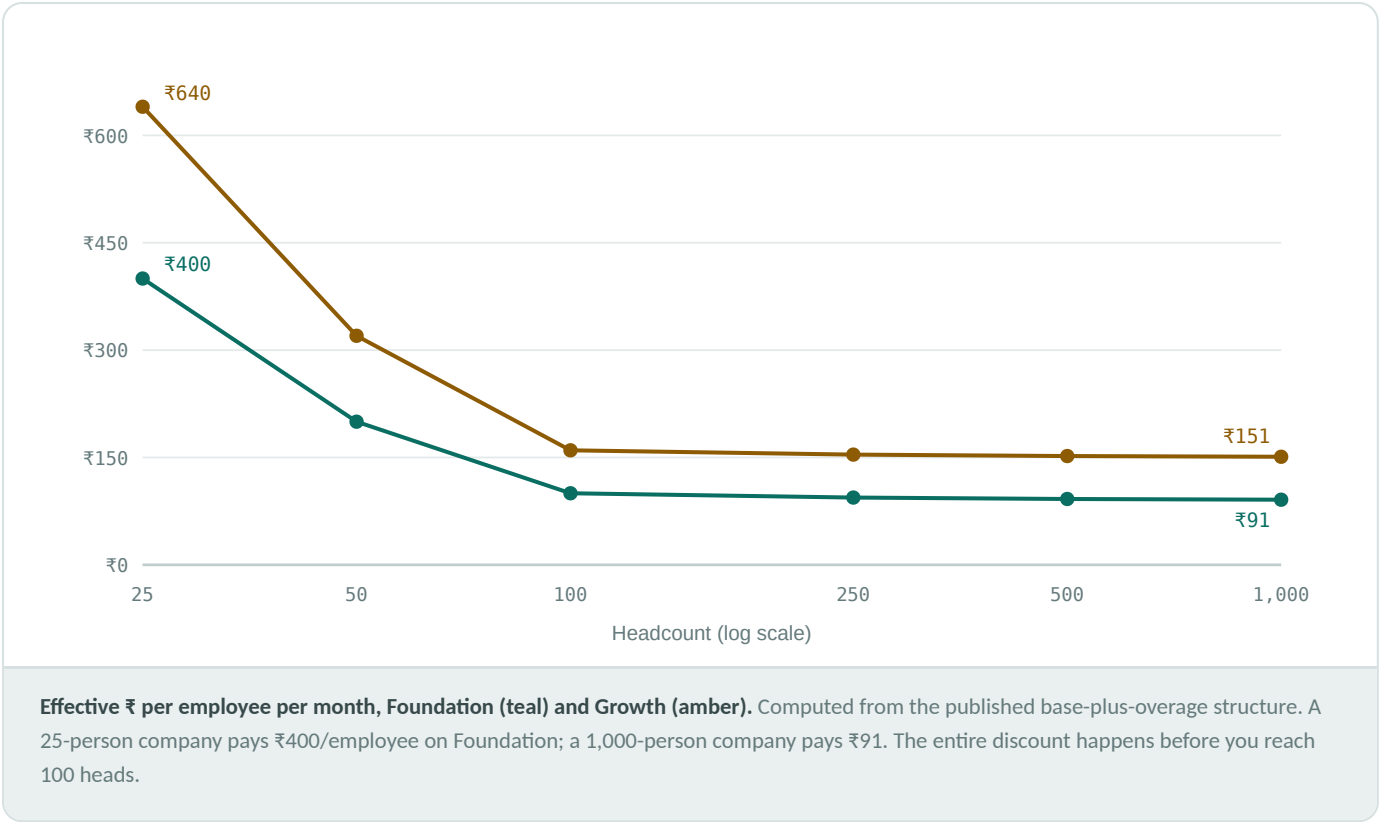
Five independent listings agree on the base figures (SaaSworthy, updated Mar 2025; Techjockey; TechnologyCounter; hr.software, Sep 2026; plus a competitor blog whose core list matches the neutral sources). The taglines are

KEKA DOCS

 — they are in the page source even though the prices are not.

The shape of the curve

Because the first 100 employees are a flat block, effective cost per employee per month collapses as you grow and then flattens almost immediately. There is **no published volume discount beyond 100** — the curve asymptotes to the marginal rate and stops.



READ THIS BEFORE SHORTLISTING

Below roughly 75 employees Keka is **2-4× the market rate**. A 25-person company pays ₹9,999/month where greytHR Essential is ₹2,495, Zoho Payroll Standard is ₹1,250, and Kredily is free with no employee cap. Keka's own "startup pricing — contact us" line exists precisely to paper over this gap; ask for it explicitly if you are under 100 heads.

KEKA DOCS

United States — a genuinely different SKU

PLAN	USD / EMPLOYEE / MONTH	NOTES
Foundation	\$9	Straight per-employee pricing with no 100-employee base block . Federal and state tax filing, direct deposit and benefits tracking included at all tiers. All-50-state coverage claimed. THIRD PARTY
Strength	\$16	
Growth	\$22	

These are not conversions of the India price — $\text{₹}9,999 \div 100 \div 88 \approx \1.14 , nowhere near \$9. The US is roughly **8-9× the India economics** per employee. Beware aggregators publishing "\$111 / \$144 / \$178" or "\$96 / \$137 / \$192" as US or UAE pricing: both back out cleanly to the India rupee figures at different FX rates, and the second set uses the 2024 prices.

THIRD PARTY

UAE / Middle East

A pricing page exists at `keka.com/ae/pricing` showing the same three tiers plus Hire and PSA, but **publishes no AED or USD figures at all**. Sales line +971 506862302. Two discount programmes are stated verbatim on that page

KEKA DOCS

:

- **Startup pricing** — "We love startups and small businesses... Contact us for special pricing."
- **Blue-collar pricing** — "For employees who do not need login access, contact us for discounted pricing." Commercially significant for factories, retail and logistics with large non-login workforces.

Add-ons

ADD - ON	UNIT	PRICE	GRADE
Keka Hire — Pro Career portal, requisitions, interview scheduling and scorecards, offer letters, candidate portal, pre-joining tasks, welcome buddies, probation confirmation. Capped at 10 active jobs.	per recruiter / month	₹1,500	THIRD PARTY
Keka Hire — Advanced Adds unlimited job posting, offer approval workflow, custom roles, internal job board.	per recruiter / month	₹2,500	THIRD PARTY
Keka PSA — Basic / Advance / Scale	quote only	Not published	KEKA DOCS
Keka Learn (LMS)	per employee / month, min 50	₹60	UNVERIFIED — single source
Payroll for multiple legal entities · Advanced shift scheduler · Timesheet · API & webhooks · Helpdesk · Travel desk · Asset tracking · GPS/selfie attendance · Continuous location punching · Pulse surveys · Rewards · Learning · Exit surveys · Performance reviews · Skill matrix · SMART goals · OKRs	named add-ons	Not published	KEKA DOCS

Third-party editorial additionally names **Distance Calculator** and **expense receipt parsing** as chargeable. No price was found anywhere for helpdesk, expense, or background verification. There is **no evidence Keka sells biometric hardware** or charges a per-device fee — its help centre says its team handles the integration, with no charge stated. **UNVERIFIED**

Setup fee, trial and cancellation terms

TERM	POSITION	GRADE
Setup / implementation fee	Exists. Verbatim: "Our guided configuration of Payroll, import of employee information, and past month salary information, costs a nominal setup fee ." Compliance and salary-structure guidance is included in it at no extra cost. Amount never published.	KEKA DOCS
— rumoured amount	2× the monthly subscription, one-time. Single source, published by a direct competitor. Roughly ₹20,000 / ₹26,000 / ₹32,000 at 100 employees. The only concrete number anywhere; treat it as a figure to test in negotiation.	UNVERIFIED
Free trial	7 days, per Keka's own signup domain. Whether a card is required is not stated. Editorial coverage reports the trial is gated behind a sales demo.	KEKA DOCS
Lock-in	Verbatim: "You can cancel your Keka account at any time with no fees and there is no lock-in period."	KEKA DOCS
Refunds	No prorated refunds. The account stays active to the end of the current billing period.	KEKA DOCS
Annual / half-yearly discount	Confirmed to exist; amount not published. A competitor claims 15% annual / 10% half-yearly.	THIRD PARTY
GST	Prices are listed exclusive of tax. 18% is India's standard SaaS rate and is almost certainly what appears on the invoice, but Keka does not publish it.	THIRD PARTY
Billing start date	A competitor claims billing starts at contract signature rather than go-live, and that quarterly minimum billing applies. Self-serving and unverified — but materially expensive if true, so get it in writing.	UNVERIFIED

WHAT "NO LOCK-IN" REALLY MEANS

Reading the FAQ together with the refund clause: no multi-year contract and no termination penalty, but **not** month-to-month flexibility. You are billed for the committed period, cancelling mid-period returns nothing, and the setup fee is sunk regardless. Honest summary: *no penalty to leave, but no money back either.*

Where Keka sits against the field

Normalised to a 100-employee company, ex-GST. Scope differs sharply between these products, so read this as a price-point map, not a value judgement — Keka Growth bundles full performance management that most of the cheaper options charge extra for.

VENDOR / PLAN	MONTHLY TOTAL	₹ PER EMPLOYEE	NOTE
Pocket HRMS Standard	₹2,995	₹29.95	Source lists two conflicting prices
greythR Essential	₹4,745	₹47.45	50-employee base block, ₹45 above
Qandle Regular	₹4,950	₹49.50	Flat
Zoho Payroll Standard	₹5,000	₹50.00	Payroll only; free ≤10 employees
Zoho People Essential HR	₹6,000	₹60.00	No payroll
sumHR Basic	₹6,900	₹69.00	Billed annually
RazorpayX Elite	₹8,499	₹84.99	Max 100 employees
greythR Growth	₹8,745	₹87.45	No ATS, no performance module
HROne Basic	₹9,900	₹99.00	Same base-plus-overage shape
Keka Foundation	₹9,999	₹100.00	—
sumHR Advanced	₹11,900	₹119.00	
Zoho People Professional	₹12,000	₹120.00	Still no payroll
Keka Strength	₹12,999	₹130.00	—
HROne Professional	₹13,000	₹130.00	Within 1% of Keka on both tiers
Keka Growth	₹15,999	₹160.00	Most expensive published PEPM in this set
Darwinbox · ZingHR	Quote only	—	Darwinbox offers no free trial

Two things worth noticing. **HROne — the vendor publishing the most aggressive "Keka is expensive" content — prices within 1% of Keka** at 100 employees on both comparable tiers. And greythR's own add-on rates are a useful benchmark for Keka's unpublished ones: PMS ₹35–45, timesheets ₹35, expense ₹35, GPS tracking ₹140 per user/month, and Recruit at ₹2,500 per recruiter — identical to Keka Hire Advanced.

THIRD PARTY

PART 04

What is in each plan

Keka's tiers are cumulative — Strength includes all of Foundation, Growth includes all of Strength. This matrix is transcribed from the feature lists on Keka's own pricing page, which render reliably even though the prices do not.

- ALL FEATURES
- FOUNDATION ONLY
- ADDED IN STRENGTH
- ADDED IN GROWTH

FEATURE	FOUNDATION	STRENGTH	GROWTH
Interactive employee profile	●	●	●
Document storage & generation	●	●	●
Employee onboarding	●	●	●
Employee life cycle tracker	●	●	●
Standard access roles	●	●	●
Dashboards and analytics	●	●	●
Advanced leave management	●	●	●
Gamified attendance system	●	●	●
Advanced shift scheduler	●	●	●
Overtime automation	●	●	●
Timesheet (basic, not PSA)	●	●	●
Payroll automation	●	●	●
Statutory compliance	●	●	●
Payroll for multiple legal entities	●	●	●
Employee tax management	●	●	●
Accounting integration	●	●	●
Loan tracking · Benefits tracking	●	●	●
Expense management	●	●	●
API & webhooks	●	●	●
Helpdesk	●	●	●
Email login, mobile app, notification centre	●	●	●
Single sign-on	—	●	●
Login using mobile OTP	—	●	●
Advanced roles & permissions	—	●	●
GPS / selfie attendance (incl. geo-fencing)	—	●	●
Continuous location punching	—	●	●
Custom reports builder	—	●	●
Custom notifications	—	●	●
Slack and MS Teams integration	—	●	●
Asset tracking	—	●	●
Travel desk	—	●	●
Employee exit surveys	—	●	●
Employee timeline plus · onboarding plus	—	●	●
Cyclic performance reviews	—	—	●

FEATURE	FOUNDATION	STRENGTH	GROWTH
Performance analytics · performance declaration	—	—	●
Bands and calibration (bell curve, 9-box)	—	—	●
Skill matrix	—	—	●
SMART goal setting · goals alignment · OKRs	—	—	●
Goals monitoring	—	—	●
Employee pulse surveys	—	—	●
One-on-one meetings · continuous feedback	—	—	●
Public praise · employee expression wall	—	—	●
Performance improvement plan (PIP)	—	—	●
Training need identification · people analytics	—	—	●

Showing all 44 features across the three tiers.

THE FOUR GATING DECISIONS THAT CATCH PEOPLE OUT

- **SSO is not in the entry tier.** If your security policy mandates SSO, your floor is Strength — a 30% uplift before you have evaluated a single feature.
- **GPS, selfie attendance and geo-fencing are Strength.** Foundation gives you biometric integration, shifts, overtime and leave, but field-force attendance costs a tier more. Companies buy Foundation for a distributed workforce and discover this in week three.
- **All of performance and engagement is Growth-only.** There is no partial performance module. Reviews, OKRs, 1:1s, pulse, praise and PIP arrive together at the top tier or not at all.
- **Payroll for multiple legal entities is in Foundation** — genuinely generous, and unusual. But a competitor reports a per-entity surcharge for multi-GSTIN setups; confirm this, because the pricing page also lists multi-entity payroll among the named add-ons. UNVERIFIED

Add-on tier splits

Keka Hire: Pro vs Advanced

Advanced-only: unlimited job posting, offer approval workflow, custom roles and permissions, internal job board.

Pro's hard ceiling is **10 active jobs**. If you need an offer approval chain or an internal job board, you are on Advanced.

KEKA DOCS

PSA: Basic vs Advance vs Scale

Basic: time tracking, timesheet rules, project expenses, approvals, task planning, revenue tracking.

Advance adds: resource planning, resource requests, project health, T&M and milestone billing, invoicing, skills.

Scale adds: sales pipeline, quotes, win probability, resource projections and revenue forecasting, client portal, customer NPS. KEKA DOCS

The PSA paywall inside the paywall

Keka's own billing documentation states that billing and invoicing "require a subscription along with Keka PSA and are **not included in the standard package.**"

So invoicing may cost extra even after you have bought PSA Advance. Clarify before signing. [KEKA DOCS](#)

ONE INTERNAL CONTRADICTION

The Helpdesk overview article describes Helpdesk as "*an add-on feature*", while the pricing page lists Helpdesk under Foundation. These cannot both be right. Confirm in writing. [KEKA DOCS](#)

PART 05

Login and authentication

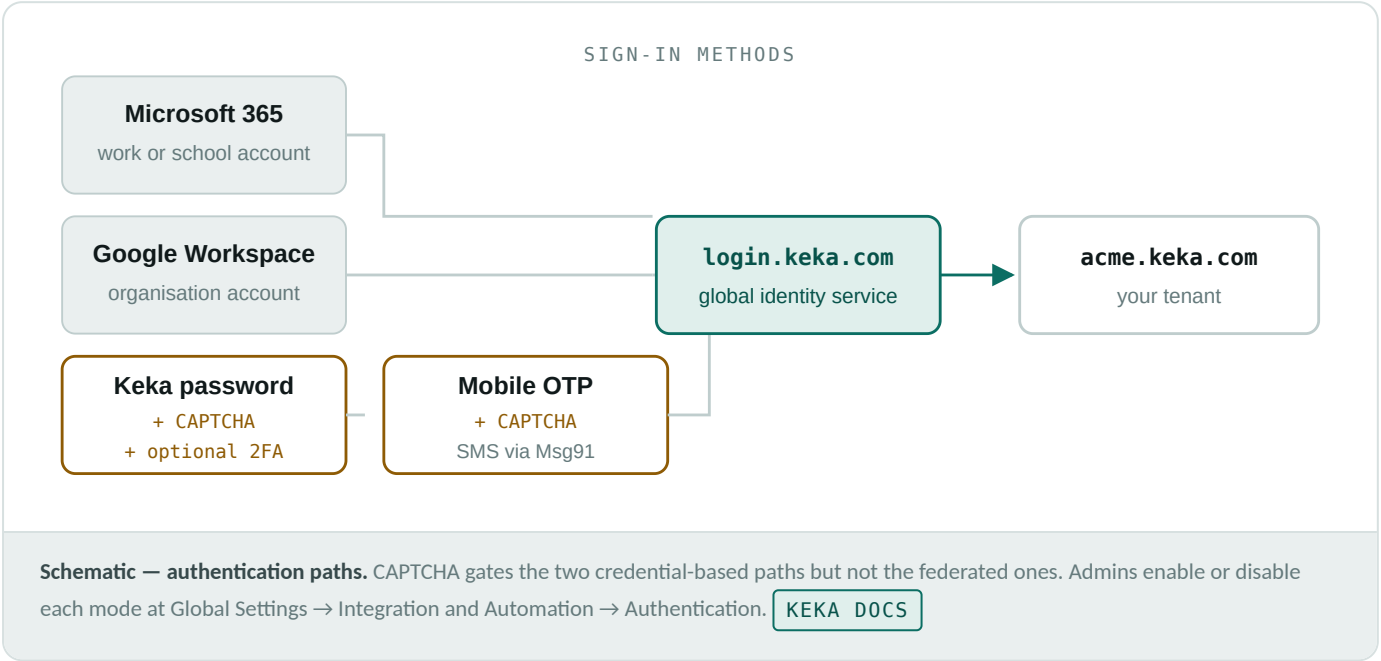
Every Keka customer gets its own subdomain. That subdomain is the visible face of the tenancy model, a mandatory parameter for every integration, and it travels inside outbound webhook payloads.

The address model

HOST	ROLE
<subdomain>.keka.com	The customer tenant. e.g. <code>acme.keka.com</code> . Every integration vendor requires the subdomain as a connection parameter — it is the tenant address. THIRD PARTY
app.keka.com/account/login	Generic employee login landing page. KEKA DOCS
login.keka.com	Central identity server. Hosts the OAuth/OIDC token endpoint <code>/connect/token</code> . A single global service — the status page lists exactly one "Keka Global Region Login" component with no regional variants. KEKA DOCS
login.kekademo.com	Sandbox identity server for partner/app development. KEKA DOCS

Webhook payloads carry `subDomain` alongside `employeeIdentifier` and `eventType` — the tenant identifier is stamped on every outbound event. KEKA DOCS

Four ways in



Single sign-on — OIDC, not SAML

This is the finding most likely to surprise an IT team. **Every retrievable Keka SSO guide describes an OpenID Connect flow** — client ID, client secret, tenant/authorization URL, redirect URI. There is no ACS URL, no SP Entity ID, no metadata XML, no assertion or

attribute mapping documentation, and no SP-initiated vs IdP-initiated discussion anywhere on Keka's own properties.

IDENTITY PROVIDER	DOCUMENTED	PROTOCOL AS DOCUMENTED
Microsoft Entra ID / Azure AD	Yes — dedicated article	OIDC ("Custom Active Directory OIDC")
Okta	Yes	OIDC, named explicitly
OneLogin	Yes	Not retrieved
JumpCloud	Yes	Not retrieved
Google Workspace	Yes	Google OAuth
ADFS	Not found	—
SAML 2.0	Not found	Treat as unconfirmed
SCIM provisioning	Not found	No endpoint, no docs, no mention

The Entra ID flow is fully documented and only a Keka **Global Admin** can configure it: enable Microsoft SSO → pick "Custom Active Directory OIDC" → copy Keka's generated redirect URL (save credentials first or the URL is lost) → register the app in Azure with that URI as type Web → collect Tenant ID, Application (client) ID and Client Secret → paste back into Keka → grant admin consent under API Permissions if your directory requires it. Okta's guide adds a wrinkle: take Keka's redirect URL and **replace** `app` with `login` for web, then add a second redirect URL for the mobile app.

KEKA DOCS

ABSENT LIFECYCLE AUTOMATION

No SCIM means **no automatic joiner-mover-leaver provisioning from your IdP**. User lifecycle runs off Keka's own employee records plus the REST API (`Create an Employee` , `Deactivate Employee`). For an organisation that runs identity governance out of Entra or Okta, this is a real integration project, not a checkbox.

Second factor and session controls

CONTROL	POSITION
2FA factors	SMS or email OTP only. The user chooses. No TOTP / authenticator app, no FIDO2 or hardware keys anywhere in the documentation. KEKA DOCS
Org-wide 2FA enforcement	Not confirmed. Only the end-user login experience is documented; no admin "require 2FA for everyone" toggle was found. UNVERIFIED
Brute-force protection	CAPTCHA on password and OTP paths. No documented account-lockout threshold. KEKA DOCS
Password policy	Not found. No admin configuration for length, character classes, history or expiry. UNVERIFIED
Session / idle timeout	Not found as a documented value or setting — though reviewers complain about automatic web logout forcing frequent re-auth, so a timeout clearly exists. UNVERIFIED
IP allow-listing	Scope correction: Keka's IP restriction is a property of the <i>Attendance Capture Scheme / Time Tracking Policy</i> — it controls where an employee may web clock-in from, not who may reach the login page. A "Web ClockIns" report records the IP of every web clock-in. A tenant-wide login ACL is undocumented. KEKA DOCS
Device binding / trusted devices	Not found for portal access. UNVERIFIED

Revoking access

Keka separates three things that are often conflated. [KEKA DOCS](#)

- **Disable login** — Global Search → profile → three-dot menu → Disable Login. Effect is immediate, with "no delay or grace period". Reversible via a separate "enable login" action.
- **Temporarily deactivate the account** — for sabbatical or extended leave.
- **Exit the employee** — permanent removal through the exit process. Exposed on the API as `Deactivate Employee`, with an `exitCancelled` webhook when an approved exit is reversed.

IMPERSONATION

Customer-admin "login as employee" is not documented anywhere. What is documented — and is better than most vendors offer — is that **Keka support staff access is consent-gated and audited**: Global Settings → Keka account & Billing → Support Access → Access Settings Log keeps "a complete history of all support interactions", visible to Global Admins only. Keka's pricing page states support personnel cannot view your data unless you explicitly grant access on a need-to-know basis. [KEKA DOCS](#)

PART 06

Roles, permissions and audit

Two role families — explicit roles you assign, and implicit roles derived from someone's position in the org chart. Both are customisable; the interaction between their scopes is the part that catches security reviewers out.

The eleven built-in roles

ROLE	DOCUMENTED SCOPE
Global Admin	Complete system access including financial data and executive dashboards. Only Global Admins can create, assign or remove user roles, configure SSO, or run bulk imports.
HR Manager	All employee information including sensitive financial data
HR Executive	Employee data excluding financials ; onboarding and profiles
Payroll Admin	Full authority over payroll processes
Performance Admin	Review cycles, feedback, goal tracking
Project Admin	Projects module — team assignments, tasks, expenses
Asset Manager	Company equipment
Expense Manager	Employee expenses and approvals
Travel Desk Manager	Travel booking requests and approvals
Help Desk Manager	Helpdesk tickets and employee queries
Requisition Manager	Job requisitions in Keka Hire

Note two absences: **there is no standalone "Finance" role** — finance-adjacent access runs through Payroll Admin and HR Manager — and **recruiter roles live inside Keka Hire**, not here. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Implicit roles

Assigned automatically from org position, never granted manually: **Reporting Manager, Department Head, Business Head**. They carry leave and expense approval, access to direct reports' documents, and department-level request management. Their permissions are themselves editable. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Keka Hire roles

Six roles, and usefully **two of them are free**: Global Admin, Super Recruiter, Recruiter and External Recruiter are paid seats; **Hiring Manager and Interviewer are free**. That materially changes the economics of a per-recruiter licence — you only pay for people who run the pipeline, not for the panel. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Custom roles

Global Settings → Roles & Permissions → User Roles → **+New Role** → name and description → select module → tick individual privileges → Save. Permissions tagged "Global" may require wider system access. Hire-specific custom roles are created through a separate dropdown option, with checkboxes across Permissions, Job, Offer Management and Others. **Advanced Roles & Permissions requires the Strength tier.**

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Data scoping — and the rule that overrides it

Scoping is a two-layer model, and the layers combine in a way that is easy to get wrong.

Layer 1 — scope on the role grant

Role → Manage Users → add users → **+Add new scope** → filter by **department and location**.

A grant is therefore (user × role × scope). Note what is *not* available as a role scope filter: **legal entity**.

Layer 2 — org-wide visibility

Settings → Roles and Permissions → Global Settings → **Visibility** tab → restrict by **Business Unit or Legal Entity**.

When on, employees of one entity cannot see, search, view the activity of, or extract information about employees in another.

PRIVILEGE IS ADDITIVE, NOT INTERSECTING

Keka's own documentation states the combining rule verbatim: "*Scope of privilege UNION Scope of visibility setting.*" An unscoped role therefore **sees across all legal entities regardless of the visibility restriction**. Managers and their direct reports also retain mutual visibility across entity boundaries. And the restriction "applies specifically to employee directory and related data extraction — other system functions operate normally."

In plain terms: **this is a directory visibility control, not a hard data partition**. If you need genuine information-barrier separation between two businesses, model it and test it explicitly before you commit. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Audit logs

ATTRIBUTE	VALUE
Navigation	Org → Dashboard → Audit Logs → Create Audit Log
Modules covered	Employees, Payroll, Leave, Attendance — four, and only four
Fields recorded	Who · when · what (create / update / delete) · old and new values
Filters	User, date range, department, action type. Not filterable by legal entity.
Export	Excel
Retention	Generated reports kept up to 3 months ; queryable history window 1 to 1.5 years
Access control	Role-based — create a custom role carrying Audit Logs permissions

THE AUDIT GAP

Audit logs cover the four business modules but **no documented auditing of role and permission changes, authentication or SSO configuration changes, or API key creation** was found. For a regulated buyer those are precisely the events an auditor asks for.

Narrower audit surfaces that *do* exist: a dedicated *Audit Logs for Employees' Finance* article, per-field job-detail change history, the support-access log, and a [Get webhook Logs](#) API endpoint. UNVERIFIED

Approvals, maker-checker and delegation

There is **no single generic workflow builder**. Approvals are configured per module, and there are a lot of them: expense category chains, loan policy chains, probation evaluation chains, exit approval, offer letter approval, document workflows (acknowledge / approve / sign), leave and comp-off chains, timesheet chains, requisition approval rules, internal job application approval, and salary increment chains. Most support multi-level approvers by **role or named individual**, with **auto-approval or skip after N days of inaction**. KEKA DOCS

Payroll has a genuine **maker-checker**: Payroll Settings → Approval Workflow defines rule-based approver chains covering two actions — **Lock Payroll** and **Compensation Change**. With it on, the "Lock Payroll" button becomes "Lock & Send for Approval", the initiator can withdraw before action, future payroll processing is blocked while a request is pending, and approved settings changes trigger a salary-structure regeneration. Only explicit user roles appear in these chains — implicit roles are hidden. KEKA DOCS

Delegation of approvals while someone is on leave is not a documented feature. The practical substitutes are multi-level chains, time-based auto-approval, and admin "act on behalf of" actions. UNVERIFIED

PART 07

Multi-tenancy and multi-entity

Two different questions get conflated here. How Keka isolates *you* from other customers is a hosting question. How Keka lets *you* run several companies in one account is a configuration question — and the answer is not the legal entity you would expect. It is the pay group.

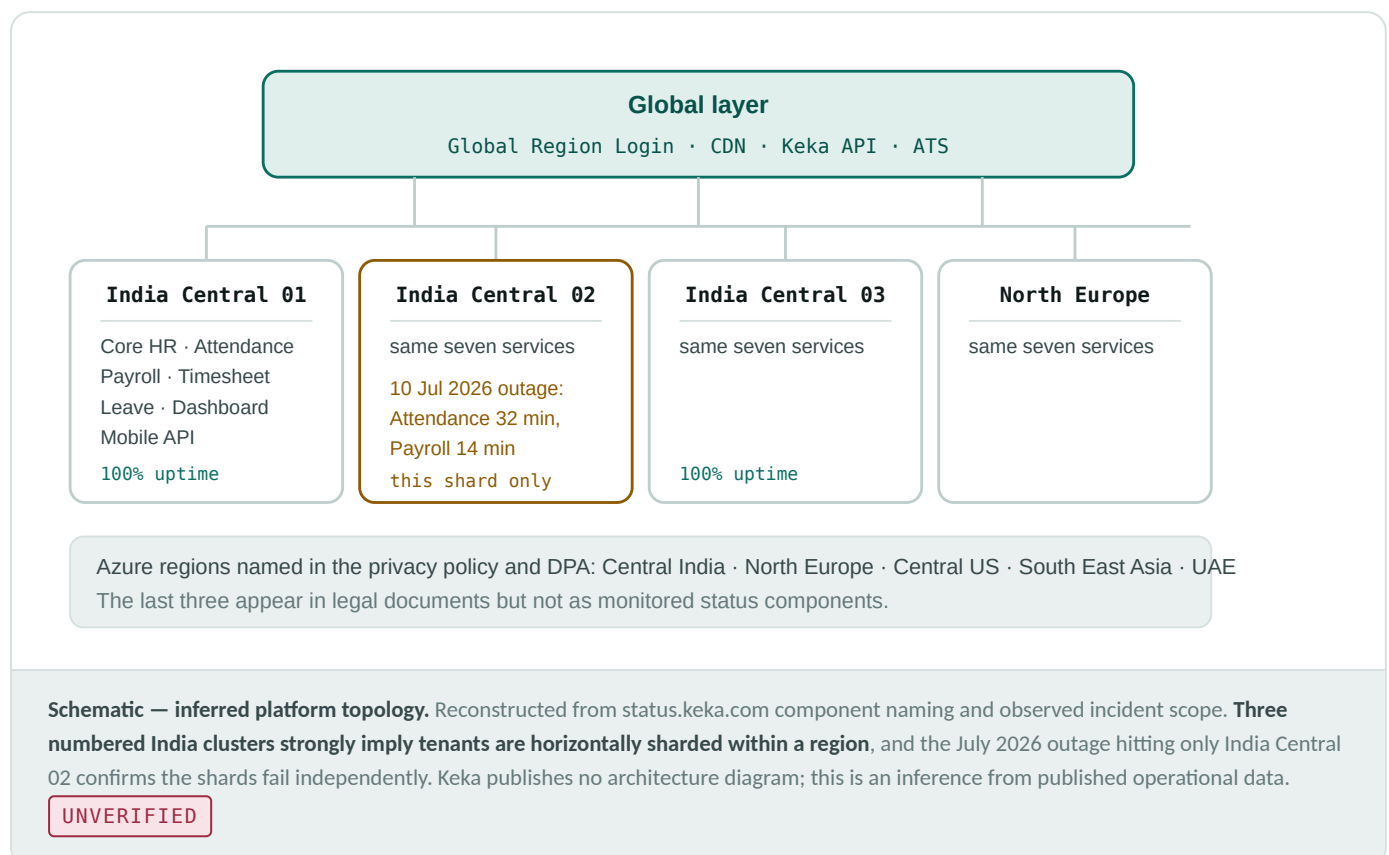
Is Keka multi-tenant? Yes, and it says so in writing

Keka's **Data Protection Addendum** states the platform runs on "*Multi-tenant infrastructure with role-based access controls.*" That is a legal-document confirmation of shared multi-tenant SaaS with logical isolation, not per-customer single-tenant deployment. There is **no on-premise or private-cloud option**, and none is advertised — the security page goes the other way, stating "No local or on-premise storage".

[KEKA DOCS](#)

The regional topology, read off the status page

Keka publishes no architecture diagram, but status.keka.com gives the shape away. It monitors a small set of **global** components and then several **independent regional clusters**, each exposing its own full stack.



Two practical consequences. First, **which shard you land on matters** — a customer on India Central 02 lost payroll for 14 minutes and attendance for 32 minutes on 10 July 2026 while customers on 01 and 03 saw nothing. Second, the attendance ingestion

API's host is tenant-specific (`cin01`, `cin02` ...), so your shard is visible to you and worth asking about. **Per-customer database vs shared schema is not documented** — the DPA's "multi-tenant infrastructure" wording plus this topology points to logical separation within shared infrastructure.

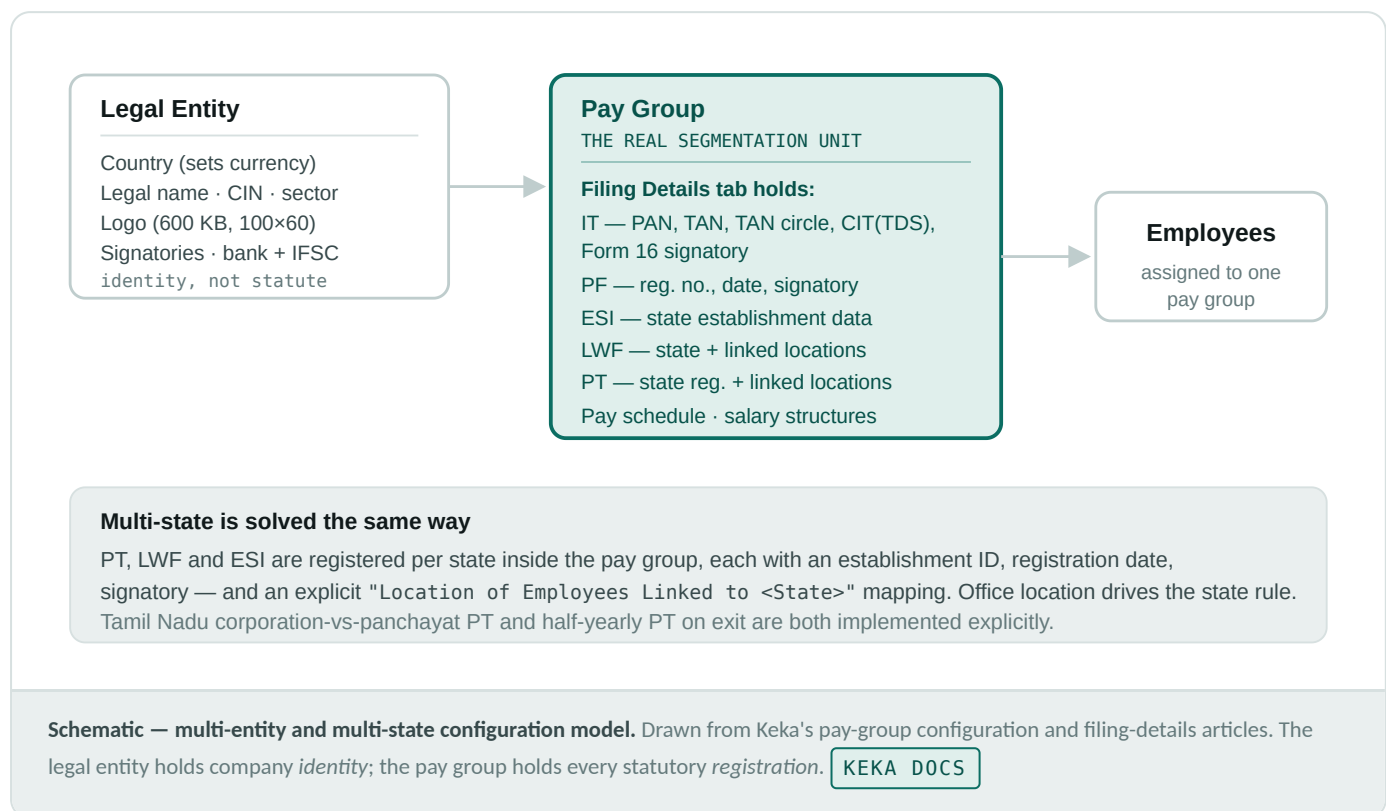
Multi-entity: the chain is Employee → Pay Group → Legal Entity

This is the single most important documented statement about running several companies in one Keka account, and it is counter-intuitive:

VERBATIM FROM KEKA'S HELP CENTRE

"To migrate employees to a new legal entity, **create a new pay group and associate it with the entity.**" This "automatically synchronizes the legal entity with employee profiles, enabling separate payroll management per entity and associated business units." [KEKA DOCS](#)

So the pay group — not the legal entity — is the unit that actually carries payroll and statutory configuration. Moving an employee between companies is a pay-group change.



Adding a legal entity — the full field set

Org → Org Structure → Legal Entities → + **Add Legal Entity**. Self-service, no Keka involvement documented, no stated cost. [KEKA DOCS](#)

GROUP	FIELDS
Entity details	Country (sets the entity's currency) · Logo (max 600 KB, 100×60 px) · Entity Name (internal) · Legal Name (as incorporated) · Company Identification Number · Date of Incorporation · Type of Business / Sector / Nature of Business · full registered address
Authorised signatories multiple per entity	Name · Designation · Email · Father's Name · Address · PAN — or the literal string <code>PANNOTAVBL</code> if unavailable
Bank details enables payroll and expense processing for that entity	Mandatory: Bank Name, Account Number, IFSC, Branch. Optional: Corporate ID, User ID, Alias ID

Deleting an entity requires that no employees are assigned to it. Document and letter templates **can be scoped to specific legal entities**, and there are country-specific placeholders for documents — so entity-specific letterheads are produced via the per-entity logo plus signatories rather than a letterhead upload. [KEKA DOCS](#)

One tenant with many entities, or many tenants?

Keka publishes no guidance on this. Inferring from confirmed facts:

One tenant, many legal entities • Shared employee directory (restrictable, but see the UNION rule in Part 06) • Shared policy library and org structure • Statutory separation at pay-group level • Single subscription, single setup fee • Entity moves are a pay-group change, not a re-hire • Possible per-entity multi-GSTIN surcharge UNVERIFIED	Separate tenants • Separate subdomain, login and admin set per company • Hard isolation with no UNION-rule leakage • No cross-tenant reporting • No shared employee ID space • Employee transfers become exits and re-hires • Separate subscription and separate setup fee each
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The honest read: **one tenant is right for a group that thinks of itself as one company with several registrations**; separate tenants only make sense where the businesses genuinely must not see each other, and you are willing to pay twice and lose consolidated reporting for it.

WHAT IS MISSING AT GROUP LEVEL No explicit consolidated multi-entity dashboard or group reporting feature was found. Audit logs are not filterable by legal entity. Role-assignment scope filters cover department and location but not legal entity. The Custom Report Builder can probably be made to produce entity-wise and consolidated views, but "legal entity" is not documented as a named filter field. If group consolidation is a requirement, demo it specifically. UNVERIFIED
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PART 08

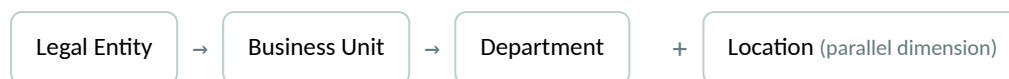
Core HR

The employee record, the org structure around it, and everything that happens to a person between an offer and a relieving letter.

Org structure

Four objects, set up in this order — **an employee record cannot be created until they exist**, which is the single most common sequencing mistake in a new implementation.

[KEKA DOCS](#)



Alongside these sit **cost centres, bands, pay grades, worker types** (including a dedicated contract-worker path) and **job titles**, which are **effective-dated** — useful during promotions and departmental transfers. Employee numbers have a configurable series: Org → Employees → Settings → Employee Number, with Prefix, Digits, Suffix and Next Number, and **multiple series supported** via "+Add New Series". [KEKA DOCS](#)

TWO GAPS WORTH CONFIRMING

No org-chart help article was found at all, and **secondary or dotted-line reporting managers are not documented** — only a single Reporting Manager field, plus implicit Department/Business Head roles and "indirect reportees" (a hierarchy roll-up, not a dotted line). Keka's marketing references an org chart and reviewers mention one, so it probably exists. Do not assume matrix reporting. [UNVERIFIED](#)

The employee record

Nine tabs: **About • Profile • Job • Time • Documents • Assets • Finances • Expenses • Performance**. The Profile tab holds cards for Primary Details, Contact Information, Addresses, Experience, Education and Identity Information. [KEKA DOCS](#)

- **Profile completion tracking** with a percentage indicator and mandatory-field flagging
- **Identity documents** — PAN, Aadhaar, Voter ID, Driving Licence, Passport
- **Field Permissions** — admins control visibility and edit rights per field; profile cards can be reordered
- **Custom fields**, which can be made mandatory and can be turned into onboarding tasks via Profile Field Task Templates
- **Add-employee wizard**: Basic Details → Job Details → Work Details (login invite, onboarding flow, leave plan, shift, weekly off, expense and overtime policies, **attendance number**) → Compensation (pay group, annual salary, salary structure)
- **Bulk everything** — add employees, edit job details, import documents, invite to Keka

Lifecycle

Preboarding — deliberately non-linear

Keka re-architected preboarding so document collection, offer acceptance and employee creation can happen **in any sequence**. The **Candidate Experience Portal** lets candidates view and accept offer letters, complete assigned tasks, and receive branded welcome content. Tasks are driven by an "Applies To" engine that auto-triggers by **Department, Location and Worker Type**, with **Dependent Tasks** gating one task behind another. Two HR dashboards track it: **New Joiners** (Day-1 planning) and **Onboarding Tasks** (candidate-centric progress). [KEKA DOCS](#)

LICENCE SPLIT TO WATCH

Basic "Employee Onboarding" is in **Foundation**. But **pre-offer and pre-joining data collection, pre-joining tasks, joining-day formalities, Welcome Buddies, the Candidate Portal and the Probation Confirmation Workflow** are all inside the **Keka Hire** licence, not the HR plan. A full preboarding experience therefore requires buying Hire. This is easy to get wrong when scoping. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Background verification

A first-class Core HR section, runnable against both candidates and employees. Named partners: **OnGrid** and **SpringVerify**, plus **custom BGV vendors** (add vendor name and logo, define available checks, import report PDFs, mark Pass or Fail) and an **open partner API** so any provider can build an integration. The marketplace also lists cFIRST, InstaVeritas, HelloVerify, Certn, ClearChecks and Checkr. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Probation and confirmation

Probation policies carry a duration and a cap on how many times probation can be extended. Two mutually exclusive advanced modes: **trigger an automatic evaluation before probation ends**, or **auto-complete probation when the period ends**. Evaluation workflows support multi-level feedback with evaluators specified as individuals or roles, an **Any vs All** completion rule, automated reminders, auto-approval after N days of inactivity, and feedback forms from both sides. **Probation confirmation letters can be generated and issued automatically** from a template set at policy level, with manual override for exceptions. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Transfers and promotions

There is **no separate transfer or promotion module**. Job title, department and position changes are made on the profile with an effective date; change history is retained and bulk job-detail edits are supported. The compensation side is handled by payroll salary revisions with arrears. Whether a dedicated promotion workflow with approval and letter generation exists is **not documented**. [UNVERIFIED](#)

Exit

Profile → three-dot menu → **Initiate Exit**, and employees, managers, HR admins or authorised roles can start it. The form captures exit reason (resignation vs termination, configurable list), whether management held a discussion, notice date, **last working day auto-calculated from the notice-period policy** (overridable), **rehire eligibility**, and supporting files. It then enters an approval workflow. [KEKA DOCS](#)

- **Exit task lists** per employee group, covering asset returns and exit surveys, auto-assigned on initiation and spread across stakeholders
- **Backfill requisition** can be raised straight from exit approval, feeding Keka Hire
- Retain-an-employee (withdraw resignation), cancel an approved resignation, remove an LWD extension
- **Bulk exits and settlements**
- **Exit survey** — Org → Exits → Exit Survey, admin-editable questions, responses downloadable as Excel. **Strength tier**. Anonymity settings are not documented.

Documents and letters

Employee documents sort into four status tabs — **Pending Verification**, **Pending on Employee**, **Verified**, **Expiring** — with custom folders carrying role-based permissions (Employee-Self, Reporting Manager, Department Head) and a **confidential** flag. Per document type you set upload frequency, mandatory status, whether it routes to admin verification, **expiry tracking**, and a "not applicable" option. Org-level policy documents support **enforced acknowledgement**. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Letter templates are authored in a web editor or uploaded as MS Word, with dynamic placeholders that pull employee name, dates, designation, signatures and custom fields. Attach a **document workflow** requiring acknowledge, approve or signature. Access is managed by role *and designation*, and templates can be scoped to specific legal entities. Archiving stops new generation but preserves already-issued documents.

Keka's docs name **offer, confirmation and relieving letters** explicitly. **Appointment and experience letters are not named as pre-built types** — build them as custom templates. [UNVERIFIED](#)

E-signature: DocuSign is documented, plus marketplace apps emSigner (eMudhra) and TRUESigner ONE, and an open e-sign partner programme where vendors receive signing requests by webhook and upload signed documents back via REST. A separate **Document Signer App** handles Form 16 digital signing. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Helpdesk

An internal ticketing module where the real configuration depth sits in the **category**. Per category: name, audience (all employees / specific individuals / groups), category head, **business hours**, optional sub-categories with distinct priorities, and **SLAs per priority level** (High / Medium / Low) setting **First Response time** and **Expected resolution time**. Escalation has two triggers — no timely first response, or unresolved beyond the expected timeframe — routing to designated employees with configurable durations. Plus auto-assignment to role or employee, optional followers, canned and

closing responses, an On Hold state, and control over who may reopen or re-prioritise. Analytics cover open vs closed, average resolution time, first-response times and monthly volumes. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Assets

Categories and types, a configurable **Asset ID series**, conditions, employee-raised asset requests, assignment, **acknowledgement**, and — the part that matters at exit — **recovery of damage charges, which flows into the full-and-final settlement as a deduction line**. Onboarding automatically handles asset assignment. **Strength tier**.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Engagement surfaces in Core HR

Announcements (with include/exclude audience filters, scheduling, expiry, acknowledgement tracking and email notification), polls, surveys, articles, a praise wall, a customisable org dashboard with quicklinks, a daily email digest, and a **digital ID card** with configurable fields. No dedicated "employee directory" article was found — search plus visibility settings appear to serve that role. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Core HR reporting

Growth, exits and retention analytics define four metrics — **Growth Rate, Retention Rate, Attrition Rate, Total Attrition** — with monthly breakdowns, department and location filters, and PNG/PDF export. Named reports include employees and their reporting managers, probation-confirmed employees, employees in notice period, work anniversaries, attrition, demography, relieved employees, exit survey responses, praise given, login and email history, disabled logins, cost-centre-wise expense, and job-detail change history. **Report emailing automation** exists for scheduled delivery. Custom Reports Builder is **Strength**; People Analytics is **Growth**. [KEKA DOCS](#)

PART 09

Payroll

This is the module Keka is bought for, and the one reviewers single out — G2 records 343 payroll-management mentions for Keka against 112 for greytHR. The run itself is a six-step guided wizard, and each step has a specific job.

The run, step by step

1

Leave, Attendance & Daily Wages

Review approved and pending leave. Resolve **no-attendance days** using "Deduct Leave". Review system-calculated **LOP**, adjust manually with notes, and reverse previous months' LOP individually or by Excel bulk import. Enter **payable units** for daily, hourly and per-unit staff.

Skip the no-attendance sub-step and the system warns you of mismatches rather than silently proceeding.

2

New Joinees & Exits

Set a **Pay Action** per new joiner and per exiting employee, and finalise any pending **full & final settlements** — all of which must be complete before the step closes.

Hold salary processing

Process as salary

Void processing

Hold payout

Void payout

Already paid

3

Bonus, Salary Revisions & Overtime

Bonus payout actions; **salary revisions effective this cycle shown with old salary, new salary and % change**; overtime payment with adjustable amounts; shift allowance.

Pay

On hold

Void

Pay outside Keka payroll

Partially pay

4

Reimbursements, Ad-hoc Payments, Deductions

Salary component claims — review, edit the payable amount, set the payout month, view attachments, approve or reject. Process **cash advance requests** and advance settlements. Add ad-hoc payments and deductions individually or by Excel import.

5

Salary on Hold & Arrears

The distinction here is important and well documented. A **processing hold** removes the employee from the pay register entirely — no components get values, no statutory contributions apply. A **payout hold** still processes and computes statutory but withholds payment, released later. Arrears arise from four sources: past-dated revisions, salary holds, LOP reversals, arrear-LOP recoveries.

6

Overrides & Finalising

Override **Professional Tax, ESI, TDS and Labour Welfare Fund** for one-off adjustments, review the summary, then Save & Close to lock the month. A **Payroll Outcome** panel then shows total employees, released payslips and unreleased/on-hold counts, with a persistent "Release Payslips" prompt until all are out.

KEKA DOCS Around the run: payroll **rollback** (for individual employees or an entire pay group), guided error fixes, a configurable **attendance cut-off date**, provisional payslip state, and support for negative net salaries in the payslip and pay register.

Pay groups and salary structures

A pay group organises employees by payroll policy, schedule and statutory requirement. Its six configuration areas: **pay schedule**; **contributions and deductions** (PF, ESI, LWF, PT with registration numbers, dates and signatories); **salary structure** ranges; **salary components**; **declaration and proof-submission timelines**; and **payroll data imports**. **KEKA DOCS**

Three structure types — **range-based** (grouped by salary band, splittable), **custom** (with per-structure PF/ESI and TDS method toggles, clonable) and **daily wage**. Component formulas support fixed values, annual-based calculations (documented example: $PF = 12\% \text{ of Basic Annual}$), hourly rates for overtime ($\text{Annual Basic} / 2920$) and **nested IF statements**. Components are either **recurring** (Basic, HRA, DA) or **ad-hoc** (joining bonus, referral bonus, salary advance recovery, asset damage recovery), set up in three steps: global repository → assign to pay group → include in structure. **Flexible Benefit Plan** is a checkbox on the structure. **KEKA DOCS**

Remuneration bases supported: monthly, hourly, **piece/unit-based**, daily wage, and (US only) multiple pay rates. Switching an employee's remuneration type has its own documented procedure.

Perks and tax-saving reimbursements

Perks carry a category, a **taxable/non-taxable** setting including **who bears the tax** and a section 192(1A) exclusion when the employer pays it, and three valuation methods (fixed for all, formula-based, or per-employee). Tax-saving reimbursements — fuel, car, internet, telephone, driver — are not taxable income, are not reported to the IT department, do not appear on Form 16, and are issued on a **separate segregated payslip**. The rule that bites: *"If employees don't claim reimbursements, amounts convert to taxable income under Special Allowance."* **KEKA DOCS**

Indian statutory stack

STATUTE	WHAT KEKA DOCUMENTS
PF / EPF / EPS	Toggle per pay group and per employee; EPF/EPS split configurable per employee ; VPF supported; PF proration and its impact on special allowance is a toggle; per-employee override; preview before finalising; PF admin charges report; ABRY compliance . Forms 6A, 10, 5, 12A, 3A, remittance details, monthly ECR , administrative charges, arrears.
ESI	Coverage below ₹21,000 monthly gross. Documented default rates: employee 0.75%, employer 3.25% , typically on a capped gross of ₹21,000. Employer contribution can sit inside or outside CTC, with an option to hide it from payslips. Arrears are included in the ESI wage base . Monthly statements, overrides, summary reports, monthly returns, Form 5, ECR.
Professional Tax	Per-state registration with establishment ID, registration date, signatory and linked locations — employee office location drives the state rule. State-specific logic is implemented explicitly, e.g. Tamil Nadu corporation vs panchayat , and half-yearly vs monthly PT for exiting employees . Monthly and state-wise PT statements, overrides.
LWF	Per-state establishment details with location mapping, employer contribution inside or outside salary with payslip hiding, proration for new joiners , per-employee and bulk override. LWF contribution forms.
Income tax / TDS	Old vs new regime with pay-group-level opt-in/out under section 115BAC and a configurable cut-off date restricting regime changes . Standard deduction, Chapter VI-A (80C–80U), home-loan interest, HRA and LTA exemptions. Monthly and annual TDS overrides, flat TDS for contractual employees, a "reasons for change in income tax" explainer, Tax Surge report. PAN doubles as the payslip password .
Gratuity	Eligibility at five years' continuous service , employer-funded. Two regimes: covered by the Act (10+ employees, basic + DA with a 15-day multiplier) and not covered (10-month average salary). 5-day vs 6-day working week handled in the denominator. Enabled per exit inside F&F. Tax-exemption calculation documented. GCC end-of-service variant on 365 days.
Labour codes	A dedicated <i>Labour Codes 2025: HR & Payroll Compliance Guide for Keka Users</i> , plus Contract Labour Act 1970 forms under compliance reports.

Statutory forms produced

Form 16 Part A + B	Form 12BB	Form 24Q	Form 26Q contractors	Form 27Q non-resident	PF ECR
ESIC ECR					

Form 16 has three documented routes: download Part A and Part B ZIPs from TRACES after KYC validation and convert with the PDF Converter Utility (password = TAN), then upload into Payroll → Payroll Admin → Form 16 — **ZIP only, and each PDF filename must start with the employee's 10-character PAN matching Keka's record**. Or use the **Document Signer App** (Global Admins only), which merges, digitally signs and uploads directly. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Form 24Q is a full filing workflow: add challans per month with minor head code, deduction date, challan number, payment date, BSR code and bank details; upload the **CSI file**; enter deductor and responsible-person details; **generate the FVU file** (30–60 seconds); upload to TRACES; then mark as filed in Keka with token and receipt numbers. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Investment declarations

Employees declare at My Finances → Manage Tax → Declaration, uploading proof documents where required. Admin controls per pay group: monthly declaration window (Keka's example, 1st–22nd), financial-year cut-off, a **new-joiner window of 30**

days or by 22 February, approval requirements, whether late submissions are allowed, automated reminders, mandatory proofs with a separate proof cut-off (recommended 30+ days after the declaration deadline), and the ability to **lock and selectively unlock** declaration and proof windows. HRA declarations support **month-on-month or annual** modes, with the ₹1 lakh landlord-PAN threshold handled and dedicated rent/landlord and lender reports. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Payslips, pay register and payment

Payslips offer **two layouts** — three-section (earnings / contributions / deductions separated) or two-section — with drag-and-drop field customisation, YTD totals or "actual gross" per component, appended tax calculation summary, loan details, leave summaries, arrear breakups, employer contributions, company logo, and **password protection using the PAN in uppercase**. Individual components can be hidden and reordered; payslips can be held back after release. [KEKA DOCS](#)

The **pay register is customisable at pay-group level** with live preview — but note that **layout changes apply retroactively to all payroll months**, and Employee Number, Name, Month, Payable and Salary Components cannot be removed. Perks cannot be configured in the pay register at all.

SALARY DISBURSAL IS STILL BETA

Keka's **salary payment automation** — paying employees directly from Keka rather than exporting a bank file — is documented as "*in Beta and available only for select customers.*" It requires KYC (~48 hours), **pre-funding the disbursement account one day ahead**, approval-chain sign-off before any payment executes, and it charges a convenience fee. **The banking partner is not named anywhere**. Assume you will be exporting bank advice files. Specific bank file formats (ICICI, HDFC, Axis, SBI templates) are never named in the documentation either. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Loans, off-cycle and full & final

Loans get categories (with interest-free and concessional tracking *including SBI benchmark rates* for perquisite valuation) and policies defining eligibility (probation completion, days from joining, annual salary ranges, notice-period status), role-based approval chains with auto-approve after N days, per-category **flat or reducing interest**, EMI/tenure caps, limits as a fixed amount or a percentage of annual salary, and required documentation. Employees can skip an EMI for a month; loans can be foreclosed. A third-party earned-wage-access integration with **Fibe (EarlySalary)** is documented. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Off-cycle payroll runs off a finalised payroll as its base and covers termination payouts, missed salaries, bonuses and commissions, and emergency payments — with its own inputs, post-payroll actions and distinguishable payslips.

Full & final settlement computes across six groups: **Leave** (LOP reversals, overrides, arrear LOP, encashment) · **Salary** (arrears, revisions, bonuses) · **Others** (notice period buyout, gratuity, loans, one-time payments, tax and contribution overrides) · **Reimbursements & expenses** · **Attendance** (overtime, shift allowances) · **Assets**

(damage charges). Settlement can be **one-time complete or periodic partial** across several months. Payroll must be locked for it to proceed. Post-F&F adjustments for already-exited employees are supported, and statements can be emailed to personal addresses. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Contractors

TDS on vendor, contractor and professional payments runs through **Form 26Q**. Payments processed in Keka are picked up automatically; payments made outside are entered manually (payee name and PAN, nature of payment, amounts and dates) or bulk-imported, then mapped to challans and filed as FVU or text. Contractors are modelled as a **worker type** on the Core HR side; the US side handles **1099** documents.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Three payroll geographies

India

The full stack above — PF, ESI, PT, LWF, TDS, Form 16 / 24Q / 26Q, gratuity, ECR filings, labour codes.

United States

A dedicated 30-article help section: federal and state tax filing, **garnishments** and post-tax deductions, **check printing**, benefits enrolment, **HSA coverage types**, 2% shareholder benefit reporting, the **\$100K federal tax liability rule**, minimum-wage validation, multiple pay rates, piece-rate compensation and OT, pay stub configuration, QuickBooks integration.

UAE / GCC

An 11-article section: **end-of-service gratuity**, GCC social insurance including **Oman and Saudi Arabia**, **DEWS** contributions for the DIFC free zone, **air-ticket benefits** with multi-year claims, GCC sick leave, annual leave advance. The UAE payroll page is titled "WPS-Ready", implying Wage Protection System file support.

Beyond these three, native payroll is **unverified for the UK, Canada, Australia and Germany** — an explicit gap for globally expanding organisations. Multi-currency is documented for *expenses* (base currency per policy, with conversions); whether payroll itself is multi-currency beyond the US and GCC localisations is not documented.

[UNVERIFIED](#)

Accounting integration and the journal voucher

SYSTEM	STATUS
Zoho Books	Full documented integration with JV account mapping. The best-documented account of how the mechanism works.
Tally	Marketplace app plus a setup article; Keka components are mapped to their Tally names.
QuickBooks	Documented (US payroll), plus a PSA invoicing app. Two scenarios covered: payroll in Keka with QuickBooks disbursing, or payroll in QuickBooks with Keka as the record system.
NetSuite · SAP · ProcessWare	Referenced. The SAP material is an implementation "key learnings" guide, not a packaged connector.
Oracle	No evidence whatsoever. Do not assume it. UNVERIFIED

The JV mechanism itself: Payroll → Payroll Admin → Accounting → map each salary component to a debit or credit account, where **debits must equal credits** for a successful post. After a month is finalised, generate journal vouchers and either export directly or download XLSX. If payroll is rolled back and re-finalised, regenerate and re-export — previous versions move to **Archives**, and **JVs cannot be deleted after export, only regenerated.** KEKA DOCS

The report catalogue

Twelve families, all documented by name: **Payroll Reports** (current salary structures, bonuses and bonus status, perk details, annual total compensation, salary financial information, revision records) · **Payroll Run Reports** (component-by-component comparison, pay registers, monthly and annual cost breakdowns, earned bonus, arrears, contribution reconciliations, group summaries, **journal vouchers**, one-time deductions and payments, overtime, shift allowances) · **Component Claims** · **YTD** · **Income Tax** (annual standard and detailed, HRA, investment declarations in three forms, proof submission, monthly statements, rent and landlord details, lender details, previous employment, TDS overrides, Tax Surge) · **PF forms** · **ESI forms** · **PT** · **LWF** · **Loans** · **F&F** · **Compliance**. Separately, payroll analytics covers compensation planning, budget estimation, cost comparison, employee competitiveness and geographical differentials. KEKA DOCS

PAYROLL FEATURES PEOPLE ASSUME EXIST BUT ARE NOT DOCUMENTED

- **Payment of Bonus Act** statutory 8.33–20% computation — Keka has rich *discretionary* bonus features but no statutory Bonus Act article was found.
- **Indian minimum-wage validation** — only the US version is documented.
- **POSH** — no module, no article. The marketplace lists third-party POSH training solutions.
- **Mileage rates, per diem and GST fields on expenses** — the expense policy article explicitly lacks all three.
- **Bank file format templates** by bank — never named.
- **TDS sections 194C / 194J** — not named, though a "nature of payment" selector implies section mapping.

UNVERIFIED — absence of documentation is not proof of absence, but do not put any of these in a requirements matrix without a live demo.

PART 10

Time and attendance

The best-documented technical area in the whole product — and, for a field workforce, the one to pilot before you commit, because it is also the most consistently criticised.

Capture methods

All of these live inside a single configuration object called the **Time Tracking Policy** (older articles call it the Attendance Capture Policy): Time Attend → Attendance Tracking → Capture. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Web clock-in

Office-based. Optional mandatory comment. **IP restriction** — clock-in only from pre-configured addresses.

Foundation

Mobile clock-in

Geo-fencing so punching only works inside a designated radius. **Automatic location capture at intervals** — the mechanism behind "continuous location punching". Optional approval chain on first clock-in.

Strength

Remote work

Two named types — **On Duty** (out for work, e.g. client meeting) and **Work From Home**. Request limits, half-day option, prior notice, mandatory attachments, holiday/weekly-off restrictions, and the ability to allow or block remote punching during WFH/OD.

Foundation

Keka Kiosk

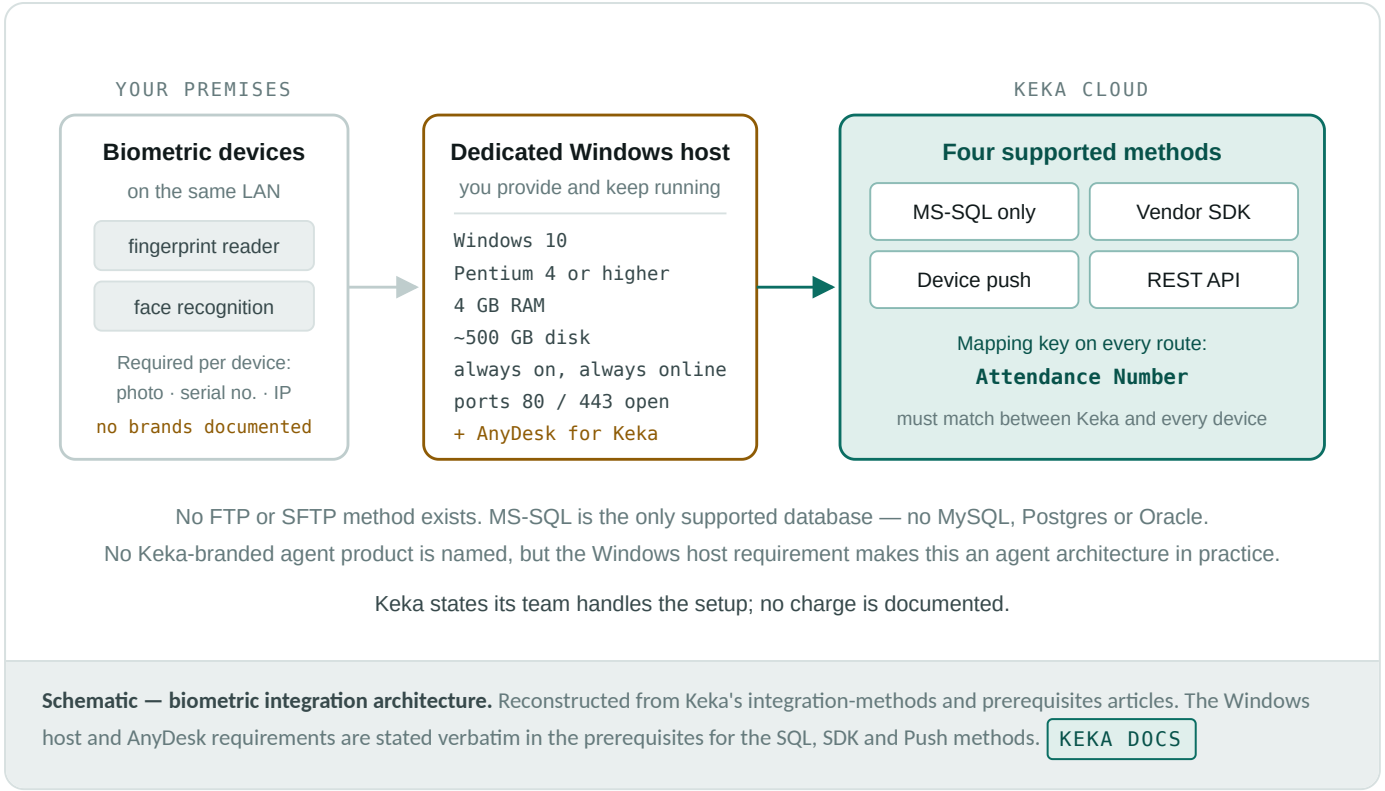
Shared-device attendance for **frontline and blue-collar workers**, explicitly aimed at eliminating buddy punching. **AI facial recognition** with a **PIN fallback** code, offline support, real-time sync. Activation via a key generated at Global Settings → Kiosk Management.

Plan tier not documented

Keka's marketing additionally names smart card, RFID, NFC and Wi-Fi/IoT capture and claims support for "**200+ biometric hardware devices**". **No help-centre article confirms the configuration of RFID, smart card, NFC or Wi-Fi capture.** Treat those as marketing-level claims. [UNVERIFIED](#)

How biometric integration actually works

Exactly four methods, and — notably for anyone migrating from an older HRMS — **there is no FTP or SFTP option.**



The MS-SQL contract

If you go the database route, Keka needs server name, database name, authentication type, username, password and table name — and the table must expose these columns exactly: [KEKA DOCS](#)

COLUMN	TYPE	NULL	MEANING
Device Number	varchar(64)	Not null	Device identifier
User ID	varchar(64)	Not null	Employee attendance number as held on the device
Log Time	datetime	Not null	Punch timestamp
Status	varchar(64)	Not null	0 = IN, 1 = OUT
Log Index	INT IDENTITY	—	Monotonic key

The public attendance ingestion API

The documented way to push punches from any system — a turnstile, a custom app, a different biometric platform. [KEKA DOCS](#)

ELEMENT	VALUE
Endpoint	POST <code>https://{assigned_server}.keka.com/api/attendance/logs</code>
Server	<code>{assigned_server}</code> is tenant-specific — e.g. <code>cin01</code> , <code>cin02</code> for India. Provided by Keka support.
Headers	Content-Type: <code>application/json</code> · X-API-Key: <code><issued by support></code>
Body	<code>DeviceIdentifier · EmployeeAttendanceNumber · Timestamp · Status (0=IN, 1=OUT)</code>
Success	<code>{ "logsReceived": 1, "logsAccepted": 1, "succeeded": true }</code>
Hard limits	Maximum 1,000 logs per request. Back-dated logs accepted only within the previous 30 days. Lost keys are rotated by support.

DEVICE BRANDS

Keka's help centre names zero specific device brands or models. It describes capability by method, not by hardware. Keka's machine-readable company page names **ZKTeco** and **Essl**, and a third-party reseller markets Keka integration for **eSSL**, **Matrix** and **Biomax**. **ZKTeco, Realtime and Bio-Metrix could not be confirmed by name in Keka's own documentation**. If you have existing hardware, get compatibility confirmed in writing against your exact models before signing. UNVERIFIED

Shifts and rostering

- **Shifts** — name, **shift code** (used as the Excel import key), **fixed timings or flexible work hours**, per-day schedule so a shift can differ Mon–Sun, break duration, and a **maximum slot duration** after which the system auto-clocks-out.
- **Auto shift assignment** — assigns a shift based on the employee's first punch. Define clock-in time ranges mapped to shift timings. Limits: **only one "auto assigner" shift type per org**, does not work with On Duty or WFH capture schemes, and requires **continuous 24-hour coverage with no gaps** across the defined ranges.
- **Shift boards** (Time Attend → Scheduler) — delegated rostering where board managers can be restricted to specific business units, locations or departments, and to assigning only predefined shifts or only weekly-offs. Changes are **staged and then published**, not live immediately. Bulk roster import uses codes `WO` (full day off), `WOF` (first half), `WOS` (second half).
- **Shift rotations** — define how many shifts are in the rotation, how many weeks each lasts, and a cycle start date; employees are moved between rotation teams with an effective date.
- **Weekly offs** — pick the days, then "Customize" to specify **instances** and whether the off is a full day, first half or second half. That instance selector is the primitive behind alternate-Saturday and nth-week patterns. Versions are tracked.
- **Shift allowances** — a two-layer model. Allowance **codes** carry a pay code and a formula in JavaScript notation with component names in square brackets (`[CTC]`), BODMAS order, arithmetic outside the brackets. Allowance **policies** trigger on clock-in timing or on specific shift assignment, and can withhold the allowance if required shift hours are not completed. Policies with past effective dates cannot be deleted — edits create a new version.

KEKA DOCS

Not documented: night-shift and cross-midnight attribution logic (which calendar day a night punch belongs to), split shifts (likely unsupported), and break depth beyond a single duration field — paid vs unpaid, multiple named breaks, auto-deduction.

UNVERIFIED

Penalisation policy — where grace periods and half-days live

Penalties are paid in one of two currencies: **loss of pay or deducted paid leave**.

KEKA DOCS

RULE	CONFIGURATION
Late arrival	Grace period in minutes; basis is either incident count or accumulated late hours ; exempt N incidents per weekly or monthly cycle; lateness ignored entirely if the employee completes effective/gross hours that day
Work-hours shortage	Basis effective or gross hours ; evaluated daily, weekly or monthly ; option to exclude hours worked outside shift timings
No attendance	Leave deducted per absent day; attendance-side sandwich rule — adjacent holidays and weekly offs can be counted during consecutive no-shows
Missing punches	Exempt N missing-log days per cycle; deduction after the buffer; ignore the penalty if work hours exceed shift hours by a set percentage
Buffer period	A configurable delay before or after which penalties apply

Allocation differs between the two policy types in a way worth noting: **capture policy allocation has no effective date; penalisation policy allocation requires one**, and offers an explicit "exempt from penalisation" option.

Regularisation

Three distinct request mechanisms: **attendance adjustment** (employee edits or adds logs within limits), **attendance regularisation** (employee requests removal of a penalty), and **partial day** (late arrival, early departure or mid-shift absence with hour/minute allowances). All support past-date windows, monthly cut-offs and approval chains. **Bulk regularisation** is available to HR and managers — and the confirmation dialog warns plainly that it *"will skip the usual approval chain"*.

KEKA DOCS

Overtime

Basis is gross or effective hours; compensation is **paid or awarded as comp-off**. Three contexts are configured independently: **working-day OT** (with a choice of counting all extra hours, only pre-shift, or only post-shift), **weekly-off OT** (all hours except half-days) and **holiday OT**. A minimum threshold suppresses trivial OT, decimals can be rounded, and comp-off credits accrue at a per-OT-hour rate or as a full/partial day into a nominated leave type. Payroll linkage is via a **pay code**, with separate pay codes available for extended OT — which is how tiered OT rates are implemented. Approval settings cover prior notice, advance-notice period, mandatory comments, maximum requestable hours, and whether past-dated OT is allowed. **Foundation tier**. Maximum OT caps per day/week/month were not found.

KEKA DOCS

How attendance becomes money

Exactly three documented drivers of loss of pay: [KEKA DOCS](#)

Unpaid leave request *automatic*

Penalisation policy set to "consider all penalties as LOP"

Manual LOP override *per employee or bulk import*

Absences, half-days and leave-without-balance are **not** direct LOP drivers — they flow in indirectly through the penalisation policy. The precise formula converting penalty units into LOP days is **not published**. [UNVERIFIED](#)

THE ATTENDANCE CUT-OFF DATE — HOW 21ST-TO-20TH CYCLES WORK

The attendance cut-off is **decoupled from the pay period end date**. At Payroll → Settings → Pay Groups → Pay Cycle → Change end date, tick "Employees' attendance cut-off date is not same as pay period end date" and choose the cut-off. Keka's definition: "the last day that an employee's attendance will be included in the salary processing for a pay period." And the consequence: "Any LOP days that happen after the cut-off date will not be considered for salary processing for that month." How post-cut-off LOP carries into the next run is implied but not documented. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Holiday calendars, dashboards and reports

Multiple holiday calendars by location are supported with Keka's own example being Bangalore vs San Francisco. **Optional/floating holidays** are a toggle when adding a holiday, and their entitlement count is governed by a corresponding **floater leave type** in the leave plan. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Five report families: **Leave • Attendance • Punctuality • Negligence** (no-shows, latecomers) • **Attendance Requests**. The dashboard carries today's headcount, early and late arrivals, remote workers, absenteeism, plus past-period metrics (employees present %, average work hours, average overtime, total discrepancies) with trend indicators and PDF/PNG export. Analytics leaderboards rank by **Most Hours Worked, Overtime Hours, Work Hours Shortage and Most Breaks Taken** — which, as far as the documentation shows, **is** the "gamified attendance system" Keka markets in the Foundation tier. No points, badges or streak mechanic is documented anywhere.

[UNVERIFIED](#)

General attendance settings worth knowing: list vs calendar display, 24-hour or 12-hour format, gross vs effective hours, exemption of new employees during an initial period, and an **AWOL threshold** — the maximum days absent before an employee is labelled AWOL.

THE FIELD-WORKFORCE CAVEAT

Mobile geofencing and GPS attendance are the **single most consistently criticised feature in Keka's review corpus** — unreliable location detection, iOS OTP login loops, battery drain on field use. The apps rate 4.7 for payslips and leave; the complaints cluster on geofenced attendance. **If you have a field workforce, run a two-week pilot on real devices before committing.**

THIRD PARTY

PART 11

Leave management

The deepest configuration surface in the product. Regular Leave alone exposes roughly seventy documented settings, and the sandwich-policy engine is more granular than most enterprise HCM suites offer.

The model

Create **leave types**, build a **leave plan** from them, assign the plan to employees. Four categories: KEKA DOCS

Regular Leave

Annual, earned, sick and casual are all modelled here. The main configuration surface.

Incident Leave

Event-triggered leave. **Maternity is confirmed** (via a cross-calendar-year FAQ). Configuration specifics were not retrievable.

Compensatory Off

Its own configuration surface; can also be generated automatically from the overtime policy.

Unpaid Leave

The only leave type that adds directly to payroll LOP with no policy in between.

Plus **hourly leave types** with their own path, and **floaters leave types** backing optional holidays. The leave year runs on a **fixed calendar** (January–December or April–March) or **from each employee's joining date**, aligning to their work anniversary. Keka will generate a policy document from your configuration, or you can upload your own.

Regular Leave, by configuration group

GROUP	SETTINGS
Accrual	Monthly / quarterly / semi-annual / annual, on a chosen day of the month · uneven accrual where each period gets its own value, including zero · unit in days or hours · quota available immediately vs accrued periodically · unlimited leave option
On joining	Prorate in the first month, keyed on joining date or a date range · no leave awarded if joining after a specified day
During probation	Accrue immediately or after N days · prorate after probation ends · new joiners can request leave after N days from joining or from probation end · maximum leave allowed during probation · encashment during probation
On exit	Prorate on exit date or date range · do not accrue during notice period · leave taken during notice extends the notice period , with a configurable multiplier per leave day · encashment during notice
Stop conditions	Leave expires N days after credit · restrict accrual based on attendance · no accrual if the employee was on leave more than N days last month · accrual cap when total balance exceeds N days · tenure-based accrual for N years from joining
Negative balance	Managers may grant beyond accrued balance · employees may take N extra days · within or beyond yearly quota · block requests based on expected future accrual
Application rules	Half-day and quarter-day leave · prior notice · block backdated leave · round decimal balances to full days · mandatory comment · mandatory attachment above N days · no applications earlier than N days before start · hide a leave type from employees entirely (admin/manager-only) · leave cannot be used in the year it is accrued · unavailable while another leave type has balance (forces consumption order) · cannot be combined with specified leave types · minimum request size when balance exceeds N days
Usage limits	Max consecutive days · max days per month · no leave from the last day to the last date of the month · minimum gap between two leaves · frequency cap per month, year or tenure
Approvals	Multi-level by role or named employee · auto-approval when the approver is unavailable · suppress per-request approver emails while keeping digest access

The sandwich engine

Unusually granular, and worth understanding if your policy is contentious. Weekly-off handling offers five trigger conditions — leave **between** two days, **before**, **after**, **either before or after**, or a **day between leaves** — each applied independently. Holidays get the same five conditions separately. Both can be gated on total leave exceeding a threshold, and half-day leave can be excluded. Then there is "**Club Sandwich Policy Across Leave Types**", which enforces the rule across different categories — so sick leave on Friday plus casual leave on Monday still sandwiches the weekend.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Year end

Five top-level outcomes: **reset all balances** · **pay all balances** · **carry forward all** · **pay first then carry forward the remainder** · **carry forward first then pay the remainder**. Carry-forward sub-settings cover expiry of carried leave, preserving the original expiry date, transferring into a **different leave type**, percentage-based splits between payout and carry-over, day-based caps, and rounding to nearest / up / down in full or half days.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Encashment has its own engine: frequency (week / month / quarter / year), permitted period, submission deadline, whether managers may submit on behalf of their team, amount as a **fixed number of days or a percentage**, minimum eligible balance, maximum convertible days, a cap on the percentage, and a **multi-level encashment**

approval chain. Encashment formulas link to salary components in payroll. **Hourly leave explicitly cannot be encashed.**

Comp-off and hourly leave

Comp-off credits are **attendance-gated** — issued only for days with attendance records — can be restricted to non-working days, and expire N days after credit. Two credit models: managers grant, or employees request with configurable periods and instance limits. Half-day comp-off is supported; year end either resets or carries forward up to a limit in hours or days. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Hourly leave supports seven accrual frequencies — weekly, bi-weekly, **twice monthly** (e.g. the 1st and 15th), monthly, quarterly, semi-annual and annual — with total annual hours, waiting periods, probation restrictions, tenure-based adjustment, prorated credits on exit, and maximum accumulation caps.

LEAVE GAPS TO VERIFY

- **Leave plan assignment by legal entity, location or grade as an automatic rule is not documented.** Assignment appears to be by employee selection or bulk import — a real constraint for a large multi-entity org.
- **Gender-based eligibility** (restricting maternity to female employees) is not documented in the Regular Leave configuration.
- **Paternity leave and sabbatical are not named anywhere** in Keka's documentation. Both are modellable, but neither is a named feature.
- The **team leave calendar** has no help article — its existence rests on marketing copy plus the dashboard.
- **Approval delegation** is marketing-only ("replacement persons"); no help article was found.

UNVERIFIED

PART 12

PSA and project timesheets

Keka's professional-services module, aimed at firms that invoice clients for project time. It is a genuine attach play — it cannot be bought standalone, and its real depth is in reporting and margin tracking rather than project management.

Keka's own definition: "A comprehensive cloud-based solution designed for managing professional services resource planning, project management, and time and expense tracking." Target buyers are named explicitly: **IT consulting, management consulting, legal services, branding and marketing.** [KEKA DOCS](#)

Billing models

MODEL	HOW IT WORKS	TIER
Time & Material	Invoiced on hours logged by resources, priced from the rate card	PSA Advance
Milestone / fixed price	Billed against milestones rather than hours	PSA Advance
Retainer	Fixed amounts billed at a set frequency — daily, weekly, bi-weekly or monthly — with no reliance on timesheets or milestones. Configure retainer fee, billing effective-from date and first invoice date; amounts are adjustable at invoicing with comments.	Not on the pricing tier list UNVERIFIED
Non-billable	Internal work — training, R&D	PSA Basic

Timesheets

The standard period is **Monday to Sunday**, weekly by default — **daily submission requires an explicit "Allow Daily Timesheet Submission" checkbox**. Mobile submission is supported. A timer exists (confirmed by the "Employees Using Timer for Timesheet" report), though its behaviour is undocumented. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Timesheet policy options

- **Minimum and maximum hours per day**, and per week
- Display **gross or effective hours** logged — this is the bridge between PSA and the attendance module
- Require pending timesheets to be submitted before the current period
- **Limit submissions older than N weeks** — effectively the locking mechanism
- Limit future timesheet submission to N weeks
- Allow attachments
- **Prevent submissions on holidays, days off and leave periods** — the leave/holiday sync

Approvals run through a configurable chain per project (Project → Policies & Settings → Approval Chain), with approvers named by individual or role, multiple levels, and

auto-approve and skip after N days. Approval can be disabled entirely per project. Hours are not used for invoicing calculations until approved.

Submission reminders can be scheduled before and after the due date, going to employees, line managers, project heads, named Keka user roles or other stakeholders, with escalation to project managers or payroll administrators, conditional criteria, and placeholders like "Past Timesheet Period". Channels are **Email, Slack and webhooks** — **MS Teams is notably absent** despite Teams integration existing at the Strength tier.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Resources, rates and margin

The **Resource Planner** gives availability across departments with filters on department, **availability percentage** (e.g. ≥50%), job title and current projects, viewable by month or week, with direct bulk allocation setting duration, allocation percentage, billing role and billing rate. **Utilisation** graphs allocated versus utilised hours with drill-down.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Margin is native, because rate cards carry **two figures per role**:

Bill Rate what the client is charged — **Suggested Cost** what the resource costs you = **Margin** project and client profitability

Rate cards exist at two levels — organisation reference cards applicable across all projects and clients, and client-specific cards — each with a currency and rates defined by **role and rate category** (Keka's documented example: onsite vs offsite developers). Resource costs are set separately with **currency, hourly or fixed rate type, amount and effective date**; multiple costs per resource are allowed so long as no two share both the same currency and the same effective date. That gives you rate history and multi-currency costing. [KEKA DOCS](#)

SHADOW RESOURCES – A GENUINELY DISTINCTIVE FEATURE

A junior assigned to support a senior on a project. Any billable hours the shadow logs are **billed at the same rate as the primary resource they support**, and invoices identify which primary received shadow support. One shadow per resource at a time; neither can be deleted while the designation stands. There is a dedicated *Shadow Resource Work Hours Summary* report. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Billing and invoicing

Invoice creation from billable hours plus other products and taxes; tax rates and tax groups; **products** for non-time revenue lines such as subscription costs; credit notes for client overpayments; payment tracking with full and partial receipts, write-offs and cancellations; billing entities and invoice settings; billing classifications and frequencies. Expenses can be passed through and invoiced — there is a *Project Invoiced Expense Summary* report. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Revenue recognition is not a documented named feature. The closest evidence is a "Tracking Revenue Reports" article and marketing lines about "track project revenues"

and "realized revenue tracking". **Do not assume ASC 606 or IFRS 15 handling.**

UNVERIFIED

The 46 reports

PSA's analytical depth is real and sits mostly in its report catalogue, organised in five groups. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Clients & Projects — 12

Client and project details (with and without custom fields), **Project Health Timeline** (day-by-day parameter changes), task info, milestone info, client contacts, project manager privileges, resource allocation summary, **Non-Billable Resources** (zero billing rate on billable projects), **Unassigned Resources** — the bench list.

Project Work Hours — 18

Summaries by department, project, client, employee, task and cumulative; daily time entries; **Timesheet Hours with Shift, Leave & Holidays**; shadow resource hours; time entry and time-off breakdowns; timesheet attendance summary; timer usage.

Billing & Invoice — 7

Invoiced hours and expenses by project; invoice details with payment status; project invoice summary; client, project and task-level resource billing summaries.

Resource Management — 5

Branch allocation; project-level and organisation-level utilisation (billable and non-billable); **Resource Cost and Margin Analysis** and its organisation-level equivalent.

Status — 4

Timesheet status; time-entry status by project and by employee; projects expired or overdue.

PSA REALITY CHECK

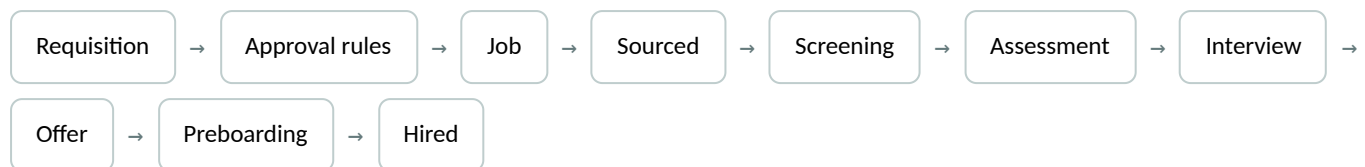
- **Billing and invoicing start at PSA Advance, not Basic** — and Keka's own docs add that they "require a subscription along with Keka PSA and are not included in the standard package", implying a second paywall.
- Forecasting, the client portal and the sales pipeline are **Scale only**.
- There is **no feature literally called "Bench"** — the Unassigned Resources report and the availability filter do that job.
- The **utilisation formula is not published**, nor any target-utilisation benchmark.
- **PSA cannot be bought standalone**. Evaluate it as "should we add PSA to our Keka", never as "what is the best PSA" — against Replicon or Zoho Projects it is not a like-for-like contest.

PART 13

Keka Hire

A per-recruiter ATS that requires an HR & Payroll plan underneath it. Two free role types — Hiring Manager and Interviewer — mean you only pay for the people who run the pipeline.

Requisition to offer



That default pipeline is fully reconfigurable. **Hiring flows** are built as named stage sequences with drag-to-reorder, and **different flows can be assigned per job** — Keka's documentation explicitly supports distinct flows for senior, junior and urgent roles.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Requisitions

Two types: **New Hire**, which supports **multiple positions on one requisition with staggered plans** (Keka's example: two in Hyderabad for January, three in Pune for February) without creating separate jobs; and **Backfill**, which requires naming the specific employee being replaced. Approval is either a single chain for all requisitions or **rule-based**, with criteria on Department, Job Title, Location, **Salary Range** and Job Type using is / is not operators. Approved requisitions can auto-create jobs.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Jobs and the careers site

A job carries a repeating **positions block** — each row with its own location, hire dates, number of positions and custom fields — plus the hiring team, **candidate owner assignment by round robin** or individual, and **Interview Feedback Visibility set to Open, Restricted or Private** as an explicit bias-reduction control. Publishing options cover the career portal, internal applications with eligibility by department, job type, location, business unit and legal entity, employee referrals, and a job preview image (1200×627, max 2 MB) for external posts.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

The **career site is a drag-and-drop builder** with branding (site name, favicon, fonts, brand and text colours) and pre-built sections for hero, mission and vision, video, benefits, culture and values, testimonials, photos, social media, job listings and analytics. Job listings can be **embedded into an existing corporate site** via an embed snippet and container ID. Custom domain support is not documented.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Sourcing and integrations

CATEGORY	INTEGRATED	EXPLICITLY NOT
Job boards	Naukri · LinkedIn · Indeed (+ Glassdoor) · CareerBuilder · Monster Jobs USA only	Shine.com — nowhere in Keka docs. Monster India — explicitly not supported.
Assessments	Mercer Mettl · HackerEarth	HackerRank is not a documented integration.
Calendar & meetings	Google Calendar · Outlook 365 · Zoom · Microsoft Teams · Google Meet	—
Mail	Gmail or Outlook	Only one at a time — they cannot both be connected.
Sourcing	Keka Hire Chrome extension — LinkedIn, Naukri, and any platform allowing PDF resume export	LinkedIn Recruiter System Connect / Apply Connect not mentioned; Naukri is posting + application sync only, no resume-database search

KEKA DOCS Candidates enter four documented ways: Excel import with a column-matching step; a **dedicated email address per job** that parses forwarded resumes; **bulk ZIP resume upload** with parsing and validation; and moving candidates between jobs. Talent pools are shareable with permission control.

TWO LIMITATIONS THAT WILL AFFECT PROCESS DESIGN

- **Duplicate detection only works within the same job.** Keka states it plainly: "No restriction on candidates applying for different job positions, even if their details are the same." Cross-job duplicate detection does not exist, and neither does candidate record merge.
- **Interviewers cannot be pre-assigned per round.** They must be assigned at scheduling time, every time. **KEKA DOCS**

Screening, interviews and scorecards

The **Candidate Profile Score** is Keka's screening automation. It scores candidates on five parameters — **job profile, skills, experience, educational degree and previous organisation** — where you supply accepted values per parameter (e.g. target companies) and assign weightage with sliders, producing a weighted aggregate. Parameters with no values carry no weight.

DESCRIBE THIS ACCURATELY

The Profile Score is **rule-and-weight matching across parsed fields, not an LLM ranking candidates**. Keka's documentation describes no model. Marketing frames it as AI-driven; the mechanism is deterministic. **KEKA DOCS**

Scheduling offers three modes — online, face-to-face and **candidate self-schedule** — with panel, duration, meeting platform, optional scorecard attachment and candidate email template. Scheduling **defaults to the scheduler's system time zone**.

Scorecards are built from sections containing skills or questions, items can be marked not applicable, and ratings use a **3-star or 5-star scale** plus a separate Overall Feedback Decision scale with customisable labels and icons. A link to the scorecard is auto-

included in the interviewer's email. Results aggregate per section, per panel member and per round, viewable as a grid or in detail with comments. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Workflow automation

A genuine rules engine, available as **job workflows** (one position) or **global workflows** (org-wide). Triggers: candidate added to a job, candidate stage updated, candidate archived, and interview feedback edited. Conditions cover candidate attributes, **source**, **screening responses** and **reference checks**, with Any/All operators and condition groups. Actions: send email (multiple allowed), move stage, tag, archive/reject with optional notification, and add to talent pool. Quick templates ship for common cases such as auto-archiving candidates below an experience threshold. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Offers

Offer templates are authored in a web editor or uploaded as Word with placeholders, and carry **"Full Salary with Bonus & Perks"** attributes so perks are represented correctly in the offer CTC. Multiple templates by role and region are supported. **Offer approval chains are an Advanced-tier feature** — single approver through multi-level, with Keka's own recommended pattern being HR, then Finance and Department Head. Changes to an approval workflow apply to the next generated offer, not to ones already in flight. Salary component overrides, including "over and above annual salary" components, **map automatically to employee compensation after acceptance**.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Signatures are managed in the Hire portal — upload a signature image and associate it with the signing employee, or import one already stored in Keka HR. DocuSign is referenced for digital signing; **Adobe Sign is not mentioned**.

On the preboarding page, recruiters can **revise offers** (role, compensation, start date), send reminders in bulk, change onboarding tasks, **revoke offers in bulk**, convert a candidate to an employee record, release for approval and archive.

External recruiters and internal mobility

Sourcing-only external recruiters are a well-thought-out role: they see and manage only candidates they personally added, have no visibility into other applicants or job activity, are excluded from candidate-owner assignment, and cannot manage interviews or stages. Their candidates appear as inbound with a "Sourced by" attribution. Conversion runs one way only — external-sourcing to internal is allowed, internal to external is not. A companion article covers a **lock-in period for agency-submitted candidates**. [KEKA DOCS](#)

The **internal job board** (Advanced tier) enforces eligibility by minimum time in the organisation and minimum time in current role, with optional multi-level approval by designation and auto-approval when approvers are unavailable. **Employee referrals** carry a free-text referral policy shown at referral time and an option to show rejection reasons to the referrer — but **referral bonus payout automation is not documented**.

Analytics

Four headline KPIs: **hiring health** (positions yet to close), **offer acceptance rate**, **time to hire** and **source-to-hire conversion**. Insights widgets named in the docs include application sources, open and hired positions, offer acceptance by department, candidate pipeline movement, **time spent on stages** (funnel bottlenecks) and an individual recruiter report. A **Panel Member Activity** table tracks jobs assigned, scheduled interviews, feedback given %, hires and **average feedback time** — useful for chasing slow panellists. [KEKA DOCS](#)

A DEFINITION WORTH CHECKING AGAINST YOUR OWN

Keka defines **time to hire** as *"the total time it takes to fill a job — from the moment a position is created to when it's successfully closed."* That is conventionally **time-to-fill**, not time-to-hire. Be careful comparing this metric against another vendor's.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

AI in Keka Hire

Two documented features, and only two: **AI-generated interview questions** (skill-based, role-specific, generated from job data and interview context, with the explicit caveat that "Keka AI only suggests questions — interviewers must evaluate candidate responses independently") and **AI summaries of interview feedback**, which analyse multiple feedback entries for patterns and filter biased or vague language into objective phrasing, producing strengths, areas for improvement and a neutral recommendation while leaving original comments visible. **AI job-description generation** appears in the requisition flow and is stated to be integrated with OpenAI.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Not documented anywhere: LLM resume screening or candidate ranking, AI candidate matching beyond the profile score, an AI sourcing agent or chatbot, AI video interviewing. Do not claim these. [UNVERIFIED](#)

Compliance in Hire

The compliance section is **US EEO only** — an EEO form toggle, federal contractor vs non-federal org type driving which demographic questions appear, consolidated and per-job EEO reports, and automatic EEO form emails. **GDPR and data-retention tooling are not addressed in Keka Hire.** [KEKA DOCS](#)

PART 14

Performance, engagement and learning

Everything in this section is Growth-tier only. There is no partial performance module — reviews, OKRs, 1:1s, pulse, praise and PIP arrive together at the top tier or not at all.

Goals and OKRs

Goals exist at **individual, department and company** level, with goals and sub-goals. Metric types are **percentage, completed/not completed**, or **number** with an increase-from or decrease-from direction and a named metric. Sub-goals roll up by **average or sum**. Status is auto-computed as **On Track / Needs Attention / At Risk** from progress against target, with manual override. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Alignment is explicit: select a parent goal, and the system recommends parents based on org hierarchy. **Weightages must total 100%** before final publication. OKR terminology is first-class — there is a dedicated article on assigning weightages to **Objectives, Key Results and child Objectives**. Goals can be generated with AI, bulk-assigned, built from custom or Keka-supplied templates, and a checkbox determines whether a goal feeds performance reviews.

Two integrations update goal progress automatically: **Jira** and **Google Sheets**.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Review cycles

An eight-phase setup: name the cycle and choose a timing model → assign reviewers → build the form → configure the meeting → set publishing rules → manage the timeline → control visibility → map employees and launch. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Three timing models: synchronous (everyone reviewed at once — annual, half-yearly and quarterly all live here), **date-of-joining based** (how probation and anniversary reviews run), and **custom**.

Reviewer taxonomy — defaults are Self and Reporting Manager, and the full list adds Manager-of-Manager (skip level), Department Head, Business Unit Head, Dotted Line Manager, Peers, External, Subordinates (upward feedback), Project Manager, Project Admin, Client Manager and Team Members. That is genuine 360-degree capability.

Caveat: the granular list comes from an alpha-flagged article, so availability varies by customer. Nomination rules control who may nominate (Performance Admin / Reporting Manager / Employee) with minimum and maximum nominee thresholds and optional approval of nominations. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Form components, each configurable per reviewer: questions, goals (with timeframe and sub-goal inclusion), competencies, core values, projects and skills. **Rating scales** are star-based or custom labels and values, with a decimal toggle giving 0.5 increments. Goal ratings pre-fill by a documented formula: *the highest rating on the scale multiplied by the goal's progress percentage, divided by 100*, rounded to the nearest 0.5 on

decimal scales. A **potential rating** toggle lets reviewers assess future capability alongside current performance — this is what feeds the 9-box Y-axis.

Weightage can differ per reviewer and per parameter, and a **proposed rating** mechanism lets reviewers suggest while a designated authority finalises. Workflow stages are sequential or custom with **day allocations per reviewer type** and the option to exclude weekends. Visibility is public, restricted, private or custom, with control over whether employees see other reviewers' forms and when.

THE CAVEAT TO READ TWICE BEFORE LAUNCHING

Verbatim from Keka: *"Any modifications made to the questions or any other aspect of reviews **will not automatically update for employees for whom the review has already been launched.**"* Get the form right before you launch, because you cannot fix it in flight. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Calibration — the strongest part of the module

Performance → Reviews → cycle → Post Review Analysis → Calibration Settings.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

- **Bell curve with three overlaid distributions** — an ideal organisational benchmark, the pre-calibration curve, and the post-calibration curve. Hover shows headcount and percentage per band. Keka's stated purpose: spotting **rating inflation or compression**, and pinpointing teams that need attention.
- **9-box grid** — performance on X, potential on Y, each box showing both percentage of workforce and exact headcount.
- **Performance bands** — ratings auto-map to bands, and **calibrators can only adjust within configured bands**.
- **Multiple calibrators per group**, deliberately, "to encourage consensus and balanced review". Overrides require a **mandatory reason**, individually or in batch.
- **Both original and calibrated ratings are stored** for audit and comparison, and all changes are logged.
- **"Finalise Calibration" is irreversible** and locks the ratings.



On succession planning: Keka does not ship a module called Succession Planning. The 9-box grid is explicitly positioned for succession discussions and the Skill Matrix report lists succession planning as a use case. Describe it as 9-box plus skill matrix *supporting* succession, not as a succession module. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Continuous feedback, 1:1s and PIP

Feedback and praise — customisable badges (name, description, colour, icon), a praise wall at organisation or department level, and **certificates of appreciation** with configurable content. Feedback providers can be set to everyone, managers only, or managers and peers; feedback requests can be initiated by employees, managers on behalf of their team, or both. Internal notes are writable by everyone or managers only. One documented warning worth heeding: turning off personal feedback visibility **hides all past feedback**. [KEKA DOCS](#)

1:1 meetings run across six tabs — Summary, My Meetings, Team Meetings, **Action Items**, Agenda Templates and Meeting Logs. Agenda templates can be generated with AI and categorised by discussion type (review, coaching, career planning). Action items carry ownership, deadlines and progress with role-based visibility and colour-coded overdue items. Meeting logs are filterable by date range, department and status, and export to Excel. Integrations: Google Calendar, Outlook, Google Meet and Zoom with auto calendar blocking. **AI transcription, summaries and action-item extraction are alpha-customers-only**. [KEKA DOCS](#)

PIP tracks active plans with filters and Excel export. As a PIP nears completion the manager clicks "Make Decision" and chooses one of three outcomes: **end the PIP and retain, extend with a new end date**, or **notify HR to initiate exit**. A complete audit trail

logs progress and changes, and only HR managers or authorised personnel should initiate or conclude one. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Skills, career paths and growth plans

The **Skills Repository** organises skills into categories with configurable proficiency scales (levels are renameable with descriptions, and rating can be mandatory or optional). Skills are assigned four ways: employee self-add, manager assignment, **bulk import**, and **automatic assignment on completing a Keka Learn course**. Managers approve or reject employee skill-update requests. [KEKA DOCS](#)

The **Skill Matrix report** shows average skill ratings across the org and proficiency per selected skill, with dashboard gap views for the top 10 most common skills, employees with no skills assigned, and employees without ratings. Keka names its uses explicitly: training planning, talent development, succession planning and hiring gap analysis.

Beyond skills sit **career paths** (with approval workflows for changes), **job profiles** with skills, responsibilities, ratings and weightages, a **job architecture** layer (job titles, levels, career tracks, job families), and **growth plan templates** — repeatable learning paths containing goals with metric types, targets and tasks, scoped as private or organisation-wide. That is the practical home of the "training need identification" line on the pricing page. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Linking performance to pay

Performance → Salary and Promotion → Configure Settings. Managers review performance ratings, indicate promotion eligibility, select salary increment eligibility with a **proposed percentage increase and written justification**, optionally add a bonus, and submit. Approvers see it in their inbox under "Salary Increments" and can **approve, reject or edit** before finalising. Chains are multi-level — Keka's example is manager → department head → HR — with a configurable completion timeline in days.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Not documented: budget allocation frameworks, rating-to-increment matrices, and increment-letter automation. Probation confirmation letters *are* automated; increment letters are not confirmed. [UNVERIFIED](#)

Engagement

Pulse 2.0

Five questions weekly on portal login, scored on a 10-point scale across **10 metrics** (named examples: happiness, relationship with manager). Metric score is a weighted average of sub-metrics; sub-metric score is total respondent scores ÷ responses. Engagement bands: **<3 poor, 3–6 average, >6 good**.

Anonymity threshold, verbatim: "Pulse data is collected only when **three or more employees respond**." Segmentation by department, business unit, location, gender, worker type, age and quarter, with a heat-map compare widget.

Surveys

One-time or automated — the latter triggering before, on or after joining day, probation end or exit date. **Ten question types** including **NPS (1–10)**, opinion scale and star/heart/thumbs rating. A "make anonymous" toggle. Four templates: employee satisfaction, **net promoter score**, manager evaluation, post-training.

eNPS is not part of Pulse — it lives here as a question type and template. Be precise about this.

Polls and announcements

Polls support multiple-option voting, custom answers, **hidden voter identity**, and unusually deep audience targeting — legal entity, business unit, department, **cost centre**, location, gender, job title, worker type, reporting manager, **pay band**, **pay grade**, **tenure**, **probation status**, and an explicit "exclude employees on notice period".

Announcements carry include/exclude filters, banner images, scheduled publication, closing dates, acknowledgement with view stats, and email notification.

Awards and rewards

Individual and team awards judged by **panellists** rather than peer voting, with nomination and winner-selection end dates. Three reward types: **cash (INR/USD)**, **reward points redeemed via Xoxoday**, or **vouchers**, with single-sign-on redemption. Certificates are customisable — theme, logo, authorised signatures, custom text — and winners can share to LinkedIn. Plus peer-to-peer rewards, milestone/anniversary awards, manual spot rewards, and a debit option for redemptions.

Keka Learn

A native Keka module, not an integration. Courses built from documents in common formats, text pages, videos and **quizzes**; a course library with categories and draft/published states; learners invited individually or org-wide with per-employee tracking; and a dashboard showing completion rates, user trends and course status. Its most interesting link is to the skills system: **skills are auto-assigned on course completion**. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Learning paths, certificates, mobile availability and SCORM support are **not documented**, and Keka Learn **does not appear on the pricing page's tier matrix** — it looks like a marketplace add-on. Confirm its commercial packaging before budgeting for it. Third-party LMS options also exist in the marketplace: Udemy, VioletLMS, Abara and Disprz. [UNVERIFIED](#)

PART 15

APIs, webhooks and integrations

Keka's API is comprehensive in coverage and unusual in authentication. If you plan to build against it, two details will shape your architecture: a non-standard OAuth grant, and a 50-request-per-minute ceiling.

Developer surfaces

`developers.keka.com` carries guides and the full API reference; a Postman collection lives at `apidocs.keka.com`. A useful trick for machine consumption: the portal publishes an `llms.txt` index, and **appending `.md` to any doc URL returns raw markdown.** [KEKA DOCS](#)

Authentication — not standard OAuth2

ELEMENT	VALUE
Token endpoint	POST <code>https://login.keka.com/connect/token</code>
Sandbox	<code>https://login.kekademo.com/connect/token</code>
Content type	<code>application/x-www-form-urlencoded</code>
grant_type	kekaapi — not <code>client_credentials</code>
scope	<code>kekaapi</code>
Credentials	Three secrets: <code>client_id</code> + <code>client_secret</code> + <code>api_key</code>
Response	<code>access_token</code> (JWT) · <code>expires_in</code> 86400 · <code>token_type</code> Bearer
Token lifetime	24 hours

PLAN FOR THIS

`grant_type=kekaapi` is a **custom grant type** taking three secrets rather than two. **Generic OAuth2 client libraries will not work out of the box.** Keka also documents an implementation gotcha: include a `user-agent: Mozilla` header from Python and some other languages to avoid errors. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Scopes, limits and paging

Six data scopes are bound to the **API key**, not to the token request: **Employee & Org Information · Leave · Attendance · Payroll · Timesheet · Performance**. The OAuth `scope` parameter is always the literal string `kekaapi`; real authorisation lives on the key. [KEKA DOCS](#)

CONSTRAINT	VALUE	WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE
Rate limit	50 req / minute	Across all endpoints, refilled in 60-second intervals. Exceeding it returns HTTP 429 with reason <code>rateLimitExceeded</code> . Rate-limit response headers are not documented.
Pagination	100 per page, default	Envelope carries page number, size, first/last page, total pages, total records, next and previous page. <code>nextPage == NULL</code> means last page. Maximum page size is not documented.
Bulk extract cost	~100 requests	A full pull of 10,000 employees is 100 requests — over two minutes of pure pagination on that endpoint alone, before you touch payroll or attendance.
Error format	Partial	429 and token errors are documented. No general error envelope for resource endpoints is published. UNVERIFIED

Endpoint coverage by module

Broad and genuinely useful. Highlights: KEKA DOCS

Core HR

Employees (list, create, get, search by phone or email, update personal and job details), all update fields, **EmployeeExit** (deactivate, update deactivation, exit reasons), groups and group types, departments, locations, job titles, currencies, notice periods, contingent types.

Payroll

Employee salaries, salary components and structures, **pay groups**, pay cycles, **get pay register**, batch payments and status updates, pay bands and grades, **F&F details**, bonus types, employee finance (paged, plus bank and financial detail updates), add/revise salary, banks, flexi benefits, **employee Form 16**, bulk salary component override, ad-hoc transactions, component claims.

Tax & declarations

Get declarations, attachment download URLs, update tax regime, update individual declaration components, create/update rental residence, own residence, income from other sources.

Time & attendance

Leave types, balances, requests (including create), leave plans; attendance records; capture schemes, **shift policies**, tracking policies, **weekly-off policies**, holiday lists and calendars; attendance time entry; On Duty and WFH; regularisation requests.

PSA

Clients, billing roles, credit notes, invoice billing details, invoice payments, taxes and tax groups, project phases, projects, allocations, timesheet entries (including **submit**), project resources, tasks, task time entries, rate-card billing rates.

Everything else

Expenses and claims, advances, expense policies; performance (timeframes, goals with progress update, badges, praise, review groups and cycles, employee reviews); Keka Hire (job boards, jobs, resumes, candidates, interviews, scorecards, preboarding); skills; assets; helpdesk tickets and categories; requisitions; BGV and assessments; rewards; digital signature workflows.

Webhooks

Configured at Global Settings → Communications → **Event Triggers** (an older article gives a different path — the UI has moved). Each event supports three action types: **email trigger, webhook, or Slack notification**. A webhook action takes a name, target

URL and optional custom headers. Payloads carry `employeeIdentifier`, `eventType` and `subDomain` plus event-specific data. A `Get webhook logs` endpoint exists for delivery auditing. Documented events include employee salary updated, leave request created, exit cancelled, welcome/joining day, new employee added, leave approved and document expiry reminders. [KEKA DOCS](#)

WEBHOOK SECURITY GAP

There is no signature verification, no HMAC secret and no payload signing documented. Custom headers are the only authentication mechanism available to your receiver. The complete event catalogue, retry policy, delivery guarantees, ordering and idempotency are also unpublished. If you build anything consequential on Keka webhooks, treat the endpoint as untrusted and verify state back through the API.

UNVERIFIED

The marketplace

CATEGORY	APPS
Communication	Slack · Microsoft Teams · Google Workspace · Zoom · Google Meet
Documents & e-sign	DocuSign · emSigner · TRUESigner ONE
Accounting & finance	Zoho Books · Tally · QuickBooks · Xero · Salesforce
Background verification	Checkr · SpringVerify · cFIRST · Certn · ClearChecks · HelloVerify · InstaVeritas · Ongrid
Recruitment	LinkedIn · Indeed · Monster Jobs · CareerBuilder · Naukri · Glassdoor
Assessments	HackerEarth · Xobin · Mercer Mettl
Learning	Keka Learn · Udemy · VioletLMS · Abara LMS · Disprz LMS
Benefits & wellness	SimplyInsured · Onsurity · Plum · Raha Insure · Jify · Zagggle
Payroll & compliance	Quicko · ClearTax · POSH training solutions
Identity (SSO)	Azure AD · Okta · OneLogin · JumpCloud · Google Suite
Project management	Jira · Salesforce PSA · Xero PSA
Global employment (EOR)	Lano · Omnipresent · Oyster HR

[KEKA CLAIM](#) Keka claims "100+ integrations". Building your own marketplace app goes through the **App Portal**: assemble a team, request a sandbox, create the app for auto-generated dev and production credentials, set the redirect URI and permissions, optionally subscribe to events, then **install privately within 5 minutes or the install is marked as an error**, and finally submit for a **2-3 week review**. Partner guides exist for assessment, BGV and e-sign vendors. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Slack, in detail

The deepest documented chat integration, with real slash commands: `/clock-in`, `/clock-out`, `/apply-leave` (select dates, leave type, optional notes — "immediately logged in Keka, no need to open the portal") and `fetch my leave`

stats. A Global Admin installs it org-wide; each employee links their own account from Me → Apps Centre. [KEKA DOCS](#)

NO BI OR WAREHOUSE CONNECTOR, AT ALL

No native connector to Power BI, Tableau, Snowflake, BigQuery or Redshift was found. The REST API and the Custom Report Builder are the only extraction routes, and there is no full-tenant export button. Combined with the 50 req/min limit, plan a real engineering effort if you want Keka data in a warehouse. One third-party claim worth checking: that **API access carries an additional fee.** [UNVERIFIED](#)

PART 16

Mobile apps

Employees rate the mobile app higher than administrators rate the platform. Both facts are true and they describe different users.

ANDROID RATING 4.7 / 5 37.1K reviews · 1M+ downloads · updated Aug 2026	IOS RATING 4.7 / 5 7.1K ratings (India storefront)	IOS VERSION 3.3.12 iOS 16.0+ · iPhone and iPad	IOS APP SIZE 283.8 MB very large for an HR self-service app
LANGUAGES 6–15 Android says 6, iOS says 15 incl. Telugu, Tamil, Hindi, Kannada	MOBILE API UPTIME 99.96–99.98% the least reliable component on Keka's own status page		

What the apps do

Remote clock-in with location tagging, selfie verification, facial recognition, geofence and auto clock-out; leave, comp-off and WFH requests; team management and approvals; salary information and payslip access; employee directory; announcements; a real-time dashboard; **digital ID card**; asset request and acknowledgement; dark mode and multiple themes.

THIRD PARTY

What they almost certainly do not do: no mobile-versus-web feature matrix is published, but administrative functions — payroll processing, roles and permissions, legal entity and pay group setup, the Custom Report Builder, authentication and SSO settings, audit logs, API key management — are not claimed on mobile and are very likely web-only.

UNVERIFIED

TWO ODDITIES WORTH NOTING

Offline behaviour is undocumented — no offline mode, no queued clock-ins, no sync-on-reconnect. And the iOS privacy label states *"the developer does not collect any data from this app"*, which is hard to square with an app handling attendance selfies, geolocation and payroll data. Most likely it is scoped to Keka's own analytics rather than data processed on the employer's behalf, but it reads oddly on a privacy review. Push notifications run through **OneSignal**; SMS through **Msg91**.

THIRD PARTY

PART 17

Security, compliance and your data

Keka's security posture is reasonable for its segment, but several of its own published documents contradict each other — and the contradictions all matter contractually. The DPA is the version that binds.

Certifications — and who actually holds them

CERTIFICATION	POSITION	SOURCE
ISO 27001:2022	Keka itself is certified	Data Protection Addendum
SOC 2 Type II	"Assessed" — note the wording is not "certified" or "attested"	Data Protection Addendum
GDPR	Compliance maintained; EU/UK data-subject rights granted in the privacy policy	Security page
Penetration testing	Third-party firms, "several times a year", plus recurring vulnerability assessment, static code analysis and infrastructure scans	Security page
ISO 27701 · HIPAA · CERT-In empanelment	No mention anywhere	—
VAPT certificate	Not found as a formal certificate, though testing is performed	—
India DPDP Act	Referenced as a lawful cross-border transfer mechanism in the DPA. The privacy policy is framed around GDPR and CCPA and makes no explicit DPDP commitment .	DPA

THE NUANCE THAT TRIPS UP PROCUREMENT

Keka's **public security page** attributes ISO 27001 and SOC 2 Type II to its cloud providers, not to Keka. The **DPA is the stronger document** and asserts Keka's own certification. If you are a regulated buyer, **ask for the certificate itself** rather than relying on either page. Keka references a "**Trust Vault**" for security documentation and publishes a DPO contact at `DP0@keka.com`. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Where your data lives

Azure is the primary cloud. Regions named in the privacy policy and DPA: **Central India, North Europe, Central US, South East Asia and UAE** — but only India Central 01/02/03 and North Europe appear as live monitored clusters on the status page. AWS appears as an email sub-processor. Cross-border transfers rely on **Standard Contractual Clauses** under GDPR and DPDP-permitted conditions. Keka's HQ holds **no customer data except call recordings**. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Data residency for Indian customer data is not stated anywhere. There is no published commitment that Indian customer data stays in an Indian Azure region, and no documented customer-facing control over region selection. For a regulated Indian buyer this is a direct question to put in writing. [UNVERIFIED](#)

Resilience — with three contradictions flagged

Metric	Value	
Backup approach	100% replicated to multiple online replicas with snapshots	Simple
RPO	12 hours	Simple
RTO	1 hour 35 minutes	Simple
Point-in-time restore	35-day window	Simple
Backup retention ⚠️	30 days (privacy policy) · 35-day PITR (security page) · ≥90 days for DR (DPA)	Tricky
Uptime SLA ⚠️	99.9% (marketing) vs 99.8% (DPA)	Tricky
Deletion timing ⚠️	DPA: deletion starts after the 30-day retrieval window. Privacy policy: deletion begins in the next quarterly cycle. Worst case ≈ 3 months.	Tricky
Encryption in transit	2,048-bit or better keys, "TLS 1.0 or above" — a weak published floor for 2026, most likely stale copy	Simple
Encryption at rest	Required per the DPA. The public security page does not state it — a notable gap in the marketing-facing document.	Difficult
Breach notification	Within 72 hours, including nature, affected data categories, likely consequences and mitigation	Difficult
Monitoring	24×7×365, DDoS protection, application and network firewalls	Simple

Published incidents: operational only, no security breach disclosed. The notable one is **10 July 2026, India Central 02** — Dashboard 22 min, Core HR 16 min, Attendance 32 min, Payroll 14 min, Timesheet 21 min, Leave 12 min. Plus a 29-minute Mobile API outage on 2 August 2026 and a scattering of 3–8 minute mobile blips. Absence of a public breach disclosure is not proof none occurred. [KEKA DOCS](#)

Getting your data out

Contractually this is good: **no lock-in, no cancellation fee, and a 30-day post-termination retrieval window at no cost**. Practically it is more work than that sounds.

[KEKA DOCS](#)

Easy to extract

- Employee master details
- Financial and statutory details

Moderate

- No one-click full-tenant export exists. Expect to pull 15–30 separate reports and reassemble them

- Salary registers and payslips
- Current leave balances
- YTD figures, previous employment income
- Full payroll report suite

- REST API is the efficient route — but may carry an extra fee **UNVERIFIED**
- Documented export format is Excel; PDF and CSV are near-certain but not explicitly confirmed

Hard or impossible

- Closed performance cycles with comments
- Full leave transaction history
- Historical attendance punches
- Bulk document attachments
- Workflow and approval audit trails

Note the symmetry: these are the same things that were hard to *import*.

Customer audit rights under the DPA: independent third-party assurance reports **limited to once yearly**, Trust Vault access, security questionnaires, and formal audits only where law mandates *and* prior materials prove insufficient. The security page makes **no data-portability commitment at all** — get export terms into the contract rather than relying on the website. **KEKA DOCS**

Sub-processors

Named in the privacy policy: **Microsoft Azure** (hosting), **AWS** (email), **OneSignal** (push), **FreshChat** and **Freshdesk** (support), **HubSpot** (CRM), **RChilli** (résumé parsing), **Google Cloud** (maps), **Msg91** (SMS), **Mailchimp**, **Calendly**, **Smartkarrot**, **Razorpay** and **Cashfree** (payments), **Rocketlane** (onboarding). Note two operational implications: Msg91 sits in the path of mobile-OTP login and SMS-based 2FA, and RChilli processes every candidate résumé. **KEKA DOCS**

AI GOVERNANCE GAP

No help-centre article documents how to enable, configure, govern or disable any AI feature, and there is **no AI data-processing disclosure or opt-out** beyond a single "integrated with OpenAI" mention for job-description generation. No alpha/beta/GA labelling appears on AI features on Keka's public pages either. Given the data these features touch — résumés, interview feedback, 1:1 transcripts — this is the documentation gap most worth raising directly. **UNVERIFIED**

PART 18

From signup to go-live

Keka publishes a seven-step onboarding process. It is explicitly self-service-leaning, and it contains no parallel run, no UAT phase and no hypercare window. Plan accordingly.

Keka's published process

1

Data collection

You prepare data in Keka's required format. Keka offers assistance but **states that the customer owns data accuracy**. This step is the dominant variable in how long everything else takes.

2

Kick-off — "True Transition"

All stakeholders must attend. Workflow discovery and resourcing. This is the only formal change-management ritual in the documented process.

3

Configuring the system

Explicitly self-service: Keka provides "streamlined wizards and self-explanatory workflows" for you to configure, with guidance optional.

4

Biometric integrations

Requires **your IT admin** and remote access to the biometric database. A common stall point, because it needs a second internal team with its own priorities.

5

Validation & reconciliation

Verifying that employee information is accurate and as expected. This is the closest thing to a parallel run in the published method.

6

Walkthrough & sign-off

"Guided one-on-one training sessions", then your sign-off. This is the acceptance gate — there is no separate UAT phase.

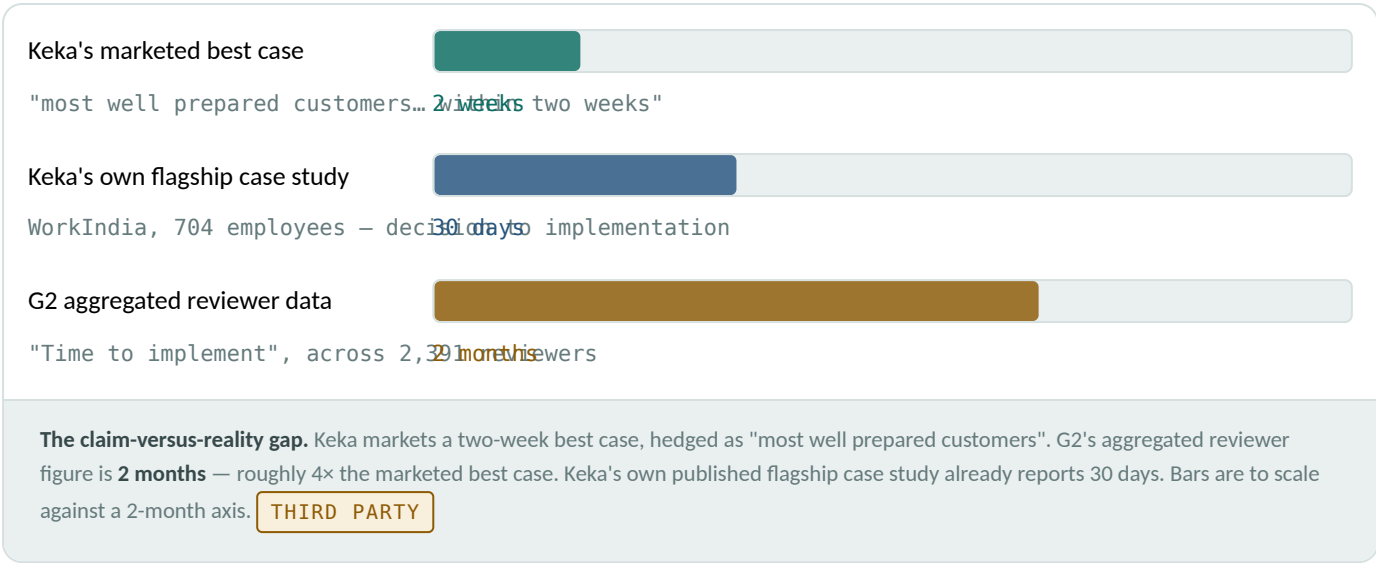
7

Go live

Production use begins. The page ends with "should you need it, our support is always there" — a handoff to standard support rather than a defined stabilisation period.

[KEKA CLAIM](#)

Timeline: what Keka says versus what customers report



A defensible planning envelope

SCENARIO	REALISTIC	WHY
< 50 employees, HR only, no payroll migration, clean data	1–2 weeks	This is the population Keka's two-week claim describes
50–250 employees, with payroll, financial-year-start go-live	3–6 weeks	Statutory registrations and salary structures dominate
250–1,000, payroll + biometric devices + mid-year go-live	6–10 weeks	YTD tax continuity and device integration both in scope
1,000+, multi-entity, multi-state	2–4 months	Where the G2 average comes from and where complaints cluster

What actually drives the variance

- 1. Data readiness** — Keka's own step 1 puts this on you and assigns accuracy ownership to you
- 2. Whether payroll is in scope** — HR/leave/attendance-only go-lives are dramatically faster
- 3. Go-live date relative to the financial year** — a 1 April go-live avoids the entire prior-period tax problem
- 4. Biometric integration** — needs your IT admin and a dedicated always-on Windows host
- 5. Number of legal entities and states** — each needs its own PF, ESI, PT and LWF registration configured
- 6. Policy complexity** — non-standard leave accrual, shift rules and regularisation policies require iteration, and this is exactly where the "limited customisation" complaint originates
- 7. Stakeholder availability** — slipping the mandatory kick-off delays everything downstream

What you must prepare

Org scaffolding — first, always

Legal entities · locations · job titles · departments and business units · cost centres.

An employee record cannot be created until these exist. This is the single most common sequencing mistake.

Employee master

Names, phone, email (mandatory) · job title, joining date, reporting manager, legal entity, business unit · employee number. Separate bulk imports exist for addresses, work experience and documents.

Financial & statutory

Via Payroll → Payroll Admin → Operations → Payroll Imports → Import Financial Information: PAN · salary payment mode · bank details · PF, ESI, LWF, PT details · Aadhaar.

Plus org-level registrations per pay group — each needing registration number, date and signatory.

Leave balances

Opening balances per employee per leave type, via Leave Balance Adjustment.

Must be done before the first accrual cycle runs, or balances compound incorrectly.

Salary structures

Ranges with earning and deduction components, tax treatment per component, and calculation method (fixed, percentage or formula).

Past payroll, for tax continuity

Keka's own line: **"Import past salaries for tax calculations and continuity (up to 7 years)"** — and explicitly optional at setup, addable later. Plus investment declarations, salary revisions and bonuses, all bulk-importable.

The bulk import wizard

Two entry points — Global Settings → Data Import, or Org Dashboard → Bulk Operations — with payroll imports living separately under Payroll Admin → Operations.

Three steps every time: **Upload Template** (download it first; for employee job details you pick a country and can scope the template by joining date, business unit, department, location, cost centre or job title; for payroll you pick the pay group) →

Match Columns → **Preview Data**, where errors surface. [KEKA DOCS](#)

- **Columns marked red in the Excel sheet are mandatory** — leaving them blank blocks the upload entirely
- **No in-app error correction.** Fix the spreadsheet and re-upload. It is a batch model, not an interactive one
- **Imports are upsert-only** — they update or add, and **never delete**. There is no bulk delete via import
- **Only Global Administrators can run bulk imports**
- For payroll imports, remove rows for employees you are not updating before uploading
- **No published row limit** was found for any import [UNVERIFIED](#)

Importable: employees; job details including future-dated changes; reporting managers; addresses; documents; work experience; financial information; salary and

structure revisions; previous salary details; investment declarations; bonuses with payout dates; pay group assignments; goals; leave balance adjustments.

Apparently not importable (absence of documentation, not proof of absence): historical attendance punches, historical leave transaction history beyond opening balances, closed performance review cycles and historical ratings, record deletion, and the org-structure entities themselves. UNVERIFIED

Mid-year go-live and YTD tax continuity

This is the highest-risk part of any Indian payroll migration, and Keka's documentation here is thinner than elsewhere. The practical mechanism, as far as the docs show:

1. Configure the pay group and salary structures
2. **Import previous salary details** for months of the current financial year already paid on the legacy system — this feeds YTD and makes the annual tax projection correct
3. **Import investment declarations** so exemptions carry over, which matters if the declaration window has already closed on the old system
4. For employees who joined mid-year from another employer, capture **previous employment income** as a separate object — prior gross, exemptions, PF, PT and TDS already deducted — by self-declaration or admin entry
5. Run the first Keka payroll and **reconcile the YTD report and tax projection against the legacy system before releasing any payslips**

GO LIVE ON 1 APRIL IF YOU POSSIBLY CAN

Keka documents **no "first payroll month" or cutover-date setting**, and no reconciliation procedure for a partial-month cutover. There is also no guidance on Form 16 Part B continuity when prior-employer data is incomplete. A Capterra reviewer (Feb 2025) reported "*the tax computation was wrong when we counted for the financial year*" — consistent with mid-year YTD being a real failure mode. **A 1 April go-live makes every one of these problems disappear.** UNVERIFIED

Who does the work

Keka publishes no named implementation role titles — the onboarding page refers only to a "customer experience team". Reviews mention "the implementation team" and "onboarding managers", but these are not defined roles on Keka's site. **Do not assume a contractually guaranteed dedicated implementation manager.**

UNVERIFIED

Keka runs a **reseller partner programme** targeting HR consultants, software resellers and system integrators, with commission on the first 12 months of client billing plus renewals (percentage undisclosed), around 12 named partners, and no published tiers.

The programme page does not state that partners deliver implementation.

Separately, an independent Keka-implementation services market genuinely exists — firms like Savi3 HR and Quickerp market dedicated Keka setup, workflow customisation, payroll optimisation and training services. That such a market exists at all is a signal:

some customers need more hands-on help than the self-service model provides.

THIRD PARTY

Training and enablement

ASSET	WHAT IT IS
Keka Classroom	Weekly live expert-led training sessions on specific features and best practices, registration via Airmeet. Whether it is free to all customers is not stated.
Video Academy	Structured video library split by audience — Admin Actions, Manager Actions, Employee Actions — plus webinars and FAQs. Many articles are video walkthroughs of live screens.
Help Centre	Three areas: Employee & Manager Guide, Video Academy, Admin Help Center. The last covers Getting Started, Core HR, Leave & Attendance, Performance, Payroll, Engagement, Learn, PSA, Hire, Helpdesk, Expenses & Travel, Billing Portal, API, Troubleshooting, IT Admin and Feature Updates.
Keka Academy	10+ free HR certification courses — but mostly generic HR content aimed at HR students and freshers, not product administration. This is a demand-generation asset.
Keka Hire ATS Certification	The one confirmed product-specific certification — 8 lessons, ~2 hours, 6 quizzes and a final assessment, free, LinkedIn-shareable.
In-app	Configuration wizards, a Product Updates feed showing upcoming as well as released items, and live chat.

THE ENABLEMENT GAP

There is no Keka Payroll Admin certification and no Core HR admin certification. The one product certification covers the ATS — the module least likely to go catastrophically wrong. For the module most likely to (payroll), enablement is the help centre plus weekly live Classroom sessions. Budget for your payroll admin to spend real time in the help centre. UNVERIFIED

Adoption

Keka publishes no change-management playbook — its position is that the product is simple enough not to need one, and the review data broadly supports that (G2 Ease of Use 9.1/10, with 805 reviews citing ease of use as the top positive). Four things the evidence actually supports:

1. Go live on leave, attendance and employee self-service first; payroll second.
Employees form their opinion on the modules they touch daily.
2. Lead with the mobile app. At 4.7/5 across 44K ratings it is the highest-rated surface Keka has.
3. Time the employee announcement to a payslip release. That is the moment self-service value is obvious.
4. Prepare for the custom-report request wave. It is the number one admin-side complaint, and it is better managed by expectation-setting than by escalation.

PART 19

Support and SLAs

Support is simultaneously the second-most-praised and second-most-complained-about dimension in Keka's review corpus. The failure mode is not competence — it is reachability.

The published baseline

CHANNEL	KEKA'S OWN DESCRIPTION
Email (support@keka.com)	"The best and most preferred way for our customers to reach us." Target: most emails within an hour during business hours
Live chat	In the web application; preferred for collaborative support needs
Phone	Urgent matters only, with an explicit cap: " max 30 minute call per customer "
Hours	Monday–Friday, 10:00–18:00. No published weekend coverage.

KEKA DOCS

Two things a buyer should weigh. Keka **de-prioritises phone** — urgent-only and time-boxed — which is a genuine constraint for a payroll product where month-end crises are real. And **support is 8 hours a day, 5 days a week**; a competitor's jab about "zero telephonic support between Friday 6pm and Monday 10am" is, uncomfortably, a fair reading of Keka's own published hours. SoftwareSuggest's aggregated claim that Keka offers "24/7 support" contradicts Keka's own page and **is wrong**.

Three paid support tiers

This is the find that changes the calculus. keka.com/service-level-agreement publishes **three distinct support plans**, each with its own SLA document dated November 2025:

KEKA DOCS

Standard
"Essential service coverage with standard response and resolution timelines suitable for general operational needs."

Premium
"Accelerated response times, prioritized ticket handling, and structured escalation paths."

Enterprise
"Mission-critical operations... the highest support assurance with **dedicated handling**, shorter turnaround times."

ASK FOR THESE THREE PDFS BEFORE YOU SIGN

The actual severity definitions, first-response and resolution targets, escalation matrices, uptime commitments and service credits live inside three PDFs that are blocked to automated retrieval. **They are the single highest-value document to obtain in this evaluation.** Two inferences meanwhile: the ~1-hour email target and "support is always there" describe the **Standard** experience, and a **dedicated account manager appears to be Enterprise-only, not a default.** Pricing for Premium and Enterprise is not published. UNVERIFIED

What customers actually say

METRIC	SCORE	NOTE
G2 — Quality of Support	8.7 / 10	1,565 raters
G2 — positive support mentions	410	The 410-vs-145 ratio is probably the most honest summary: support is good roughly three times out of four, and when it fails it fails badly enough that people write about it.
G2 — negative support mentions	145	
Capterra / GetApp / Software Advice — Customer Service	3.9 / 5	Keka's weakest published metric anywhere. Note this is one 91-review Gartner Digital Markets pool shared across all three sites, not three independent data points.
SoftwareSuggest — Customer Support	4.7 / 5	India-focused marketplace, vendor-friendly reviewer pipeline
Techjockey — Customer Support	4.4 / 5	78 reviews

Praised: helpfulness once engaged, responsiveness, and specifically the **training sessions** — the live Keka Classroom motion is visibly landing. **Complained about:** "hard to reach them on a real-time basis", "calls are often not answered", implementation teams unresponsive to scheduling requests, "limiting assistance after hours" (directly traceable to the published Mon–Fri 10–6 window), and unresolved refund commitments. THIRD PARTY

THE PRACTICAL CONCLUSION

The failure mode is reachability and follow-through, not competence — consistent with a support organisation scaled for volume email rather than real-time crisis. Keka's own answer is the Premium and Enterprise plans. **A mid-market buyer running payroll on Keka should price in the upgraded support tier rather than assume Standard is enough.**

Roadmap visibility

Unusually open for this segment: the in-app **Product Updates feed at Home → Product Updates shows upcoming as well as released items**, so admins get forward roadmap visibility inside the product. There is also a help-centre "Feature updates" section and a release-notes resource. **Keka publishes no stated release cadence**, and the public feed is not dated in a way that lets cadence be measured from outside — but mobile store history suggests roughly monthly releases, and G2 scores Keka's **Product Direction at**

9.6/10, its highest sub-score and above both greythR (9.3) and Darwinbox (9.5).

THIRD PARTY

PART 20

Verdict and fit

Keka is a strong mid-market product with a clear sweet spot, a real customisation ceiling, and pricing that punishes small teams. Where it fits, it fits well.

What reviewers consistently praise

THEME	G2 MENTIONS	DETAIL
Ease of use	805	The dominant theme by a wide margin. Ease of Use 9.1/10 beats Darwinbox (8.7) and matches greytHR (9.1). Low training burden — "accessible even for beginners".
Support, once reached	410	Praised specifically for responsiveness and training sessions.
Payroll processing and Indian statutory accuracy	343	Against greytHR's 112 — this is a discriminating strength, not table stakes. TDS, PF, ESIC, PT, LWF, Form 16 and 24Q handled natively.
Genuine all-in-one breadth	318	Core HR + payroll + attendance + leave + performance + engagement + ATS + PSA + LMS. Removes three to five point tools.
Self-service and mobile	—	4.7/5 across 44K ratings. Measurably reduces inbound HR queries.

What reviewers consistently complain about

THEME	G2 MENTIONS	DETAIL
Limited customisation	224	The number one complaint. Workflows must be conformed to rather than configured. The structural cause is the same design choice that produces the 9.1 ease-of-use score — an opinionated, wizard-driven configuration model. A specific and highly checkable competitor claim worth testing in a demo: <i>custom fields are unavailable in custom reports</i> .
Support reachability	145	Unanswered calls, after-hours gaps, implementation scheduling delays, unresolved refunds.
Reporting depth	143 + 119	Cross-module reporting is limited; analytics shallow enough that admins export to Excel. One specific reported defect worth testing: <i>payroll reports not giving accurate Total CTC — PF has to be added manually</i> .
Performance with large datasets	143 + 89 + 73	Slow loading; automatic web logout requiring frequent re-auth; degraded on mobile networks. This is the complaint that scales with headcount and the main technical reason Keka thins out above ~2,000 employees.
Mobile geofencing / GPS attendance	—	Unreliable location detection, iOS OTP login loops, battery drain. Note the tension with the 4.7 store rating: the app is good at payslips and leave, and unreliable at geofenced attendance.

Head to head

G2 SUB-SCORE (CHECKED SEP 2026)	KEKA	GREYTHR	DARWINBOX
Overall rating	4.4 (2,391)	4.4 (1,286)	4.4 (232)
Primary segment	Mid-market 74%	Mid-market 64%	Enterprise 49.5%
Meets requirements	8.8	8.7	9.1
Ease of use	9.1	9.1	8.7
Ease of admin	9.0	8.8	8.0
Quality of support	8.7	8.7	8.4
Product direction	9.6	9.3	9.5
Payroll management mentions	343	112	—

Against greythHR, Keka's moat is breadth and administration — greythHR has no recruitment module and no performance management, and Keka has three times the payroll-management mentions. greythHR's moat is price (roughly half at 100 employees, with a 50-employee base block that makes it dramatically cheaper below that) and a longer payroll-compliance pedigree. **greythHR for payroll-first and price-sensitive; Keka when you want one platform instead of greythHR plus an ATS plus a performance tool.**

Against Darwinbox, the segment split is clean. Keka wins ease of administration by a full point — **9.0 versus 8.0, the largest gap in the dataset** — plus implementation speed, cost, price transparency and ten times the review volume. Darwinbox wins on enterprise depth (Meets Requirements 9.1 vs 8.8), large-enterprise references, global multi-country payroll and deep configurability. **Darwinbox above ~2,000 employees, Keka below. They barely compete in the middle.**

Against Zoho, Keka wins on genuine integration — Zoho requires stitching People plus Payroll plus often Recruit — and on mid-market payroll depth. Zoho wins decisively below 50 employees (Payroll free ≤10, ₹40–60 PEPM thereafter), on customisation and API flexibility, and if you already run the Zoho ecosystem. **Against BambooHR in India it is not a contest: BambooHR has no Indian statutory payroll at all.** THIRD PARTY

Fit by segment

SEGMENT	VERDICT	REASONING
Startup, under 50	Poor fit	Effective ₹200–400 PEPM — four to eight times the alternatives. Kredily is free, Zoho Payroll is free ≤10, greytHR is free ≤25. The base-plus-overage model actively punishes small teams.
SMB, 50–500	Core sweet spot	₹92–100 PEPM. All-in-one breadth replaces three to five point tools, and 9.1 ease of use means a low training burden with a small HR ops team. This is where the 74% mid-market skew comes from and where Keka should win most bake-offs.
Mid-market, 500–2,000	Good, with caveats	Still strong on price and breadth — but this is where the complaint themes bite: performance with large datasets, reporting limits, multi-entity fees, support reachability at month-end. Buy the upgraded support plan and budget 6–10 weeks, not two.
Enterprise, 2,000+	Stretch	Gartner categorises Keka as sub-1,000. Customisation ceilings, reporting depth, performance at scale and the absence of large-enterprise references all count against it. You can make it work, but you will be its largest kind of customer.
US market	Early	All-50-state payroll with filing included at \$9–22 PEPM is a genuinely strong offer. But US entry was 2024, brand recognition is near zero, and the reference base is thin.
Field / frontline workforce	Pilot first	Geofencing and GPS attendance are the most consistently criticised feature. Run a two-week field pilot on real devices before committing.

Vendor viability

	FY23	FY24	FY25
Revenue from operations	₹48 Cr	₹78 Cr +62%	₹133.86 Cr +55%
Net loss	₹28 Cr	₹80 Cr 2.8×	not public
Total expenditure	₹83 Cr	₹166 Cr	—
Employee benefits	—	₹107 Cr 64.5% of spend	—
Cash & bank	—	₹88 Cr	—

Keka was bootstrapped and profitable until the \$57M WestBridge Series A in November 2022, then deployed it into growth — FY24 spend doubled, headcount cost rose 94%, advertising rose 3.6×, and losses tripled. FY25 revenue of ₹133.86 Cr growing 55% shows the spend bought real growth. **But FY24 closed with ₹88 Cr cash against an ₹80 Cr annual loss, and there has been no funding round since November 2022.** A Series B or a sharp move toward profitability is likely required in the FY26–27 window.

THIRD PARTY

HOW TO WEIGH THIS

This is **not a red flag on its own** — ₹134 Cr revenue growing 55% is a fundable profile, and the WestBridge relationship is a strong signal. It is the reason to read the SLA and, more importantly, the **data-export and post-termination retention terms** carefully, and to get them into the contract rather than relying on the website. Disregard the widely circulated GetLatka figure of "\$85.9M ARR (bootstrapped)" — it is inconsistent with MCA filings (FY25 ≈ \$16M) and with the fact that Keka is not bootstrapped.

PART 21

Due-diligence checklist

Twenty-two questions this research could not answer from public sources. Each one is something a buyer should put to Keka in writing, and several have real commercial consequences.

Commercial

1. **What exactly is the setup fee?** Confirmed to exist, never published. Test the "2× monthly subscription" figure. Ask whether it is ever waived on annual prepay or at higher tiers.
2. **Does billing start at contract signature or at go-live?** If implementation runs 6–10 weeks, this is real money for months you cannot use the product.
3. **Is there a minimum billing period, and is it quarterly?** "No lock-in" and "no refunds" can coexist with a quarterly floor.
4. **What is the annual and half-yearly prepay discount, in writing?**
5. **Is there a per-entity or multi-GSTIN surcharge?** Multi-entity payroll is listed both in Foundation and among the paid add-ons.
6. **Is API access included or chargeable?** A third-party claim says chargeable; it is also your only bulk-export route.
7. **Get the Premium and Enterprise support plan prices and the three SLA PDFs.** These are the highest-value outstanding documents.
8. **What does Keka Learn cost, and how is it packaged?** It is not on the tier matrix.
9. **What does PSA cost,** and is billing and invoicing included in PSA Advance or a further subscription?

Technical and security

10. **Does Keka Technologies itself hold ISO 27001 and SOC 2 Type II?** Ask for the certificate, not the web page.
11. **Where does our data physically reside, and can we pin the region?** Data residency for Indian customer data is unstated.
12. **Which shard are we on** (India Central 01, 02 or 03), and what is the failover story?
13. **Which uptime figure is contractual — 99.9% or 99.8%?** Get it in the agreement.
14. **Reconcile the backup retention figures** — 30 days, 35-day PITR and ≥90 days appear in three different documents.
15. **Is SAML supported at all, or is OIDC the only option?** And is there any SCIM roadmap?
16. **Can 2FA be enforced org-wide?** Only the end-user experience is documented.
17. **Are role changes, SSO configuration changes and API key creation audited?** The four documented audit modules do not cover them.
18. **Do webhooks support signature verification?** If not, plan to verify state through the API.

19. **How is AI data processed?** Which models, which data, can features be disabled, and is there an opt-out.

Functional — verify in a live demo, not a feature list

20. **Can custom fields be used in custom reports?** A specific competitor claim that they cannot — highly checkable and a hard reporting ceiling if true.
21. **Does Total CTC in payroll reports include PF?** A specific reported defect worth reproducing.
22. **Confirm compatibility against your exact biometric device models.** Keka's own documentation names zero brands.
23. **Test night-shift and cross-midnight attendance attribution,** and split shifts if you need them — neither is documented.
24. **Test cross-entity data isolation** against the documented "privilege UNION visibility" rule, if that matters to you.
25. **Run a geofencing field pilot** on real devices for two weeks if you have a field workforce.
26. **Confirm whether historical attendance, leave transaction history and closed performance cycles can be imported** — all three appear to be neither importable nor exportable.
27. **Ask whether a parallel payroll run is offered** as part of implementation. It is not in the published seven steps.

PART 22

Where to see the real screens

The diagrams in this report are schematics. These are Keka's own help-centre articles that contain actual product screenshots — organised by screen, with counts where the article states them. Open the article and you are looking at the real UI.

TWO THINGS THAT WILL SAVE YOU TIME

Keka runs **parallel help systems**. The `help.keka.com/hc/en-us/articles/...` URLs work reliably; the older `help.keka.com/admin/...` paths often carry richer article bodies but are blocked to automated fetching. `support.keka.com` and `keka.freshdesk.com` are aliases of an older archive, and when one is blocked the other sometimes works. Screenshots are served from two CDNs: `help.keka.com/hc/article_attachments/<id>` and a HubSpot bucket.

Payroll

SCREEN	SHOTS	ARTICLE
The 6-step payroll run — one screenshot per step	6	Running payroll on Keka
Salary structures — the richest payroll article	21 + 2 GIFs	Creating and managing salary structures for a pay group
Pay group configuration	16	Creating and configuring a new pay group
Maker-checker approval workflow	11	Approval Workflow (Maker-Checker) for Payroll Finalisation
Full & final settlement	8	Processing a Full and Final (F&F) Settlement
Off-cycle payroll	8	Introducing Off-Cycle Payroll
Pay register customisation	7	Customizing the Pay Register on Keka
Payslip settings and management	6 + 6	Configuring payslip settings · Managing employees' payslips
Statutory filing details (PAN/TAN/PF/ESI/LWF/PT panels)	3+	Managing IT, PF, LWF, PT and ESI filing details for the pay group
ESI settings · LWF settings	3 · 3	ESI contributions · LWF contributions
Gratuity in F&F · Tax-saving reimbursements	3 · 3	Enable gratuity in F&F · Tax-saving reimbursements
Form 16 · Form 24Q (GIF walkthroughs)	multiple	Managing Form 16 · Generating Form 24Q
Zoho Books accounting integration	3	Accounting Integration with Zoho Books

Core HR, roles and helpdesk

SCREEN	SHOTS	ARTICLE
Helpdesk category — SLA and escalation config	11	Creating a New Helpdesk Category
Helpdesk settings and canned responses	3	Managing Helpdesk Settings
Employee number series configuration	4	Employee number series
Roles & permissions — new role, privileges, manage users, add scope	1+	Overview — Roles & Permissions
Onboarding initiation · exit initiation	3 + video · 2	Initiating Onboarding · Initiating the Exit Process
Document templates · employee documents	2+ · multiple	Document Templates · Managing Employee Documents

Time, attendance and PSA

SCREEN	SHOTS	ARTICLE
Attendance cut-off date — one shot per configuration step	6	Attendance cut-off date for payroll processing
Time tracking policy — web clock-in, mobile/geofence, remote work	multiple	Setting up a Time Tracking Policy
Geo-locations — map pinning, radius, employee assignment	multiple	Creating Geo Locations
LOP drivers — leave request, penalisation config, LOP override, bulk import	multiple	What impacts Loss of Pay
Comp-off configuration	3	Configuring a Comp-off
Keka Kiosk — app, face registration, activation key	multiple	Keka Kiosk
Biometric integration getting started	1	Biometric device integration
Shifts · shift boards and rotations · weekly offs	3 · multiple · 2	Shifts · Shift boards · Weekly offs
PSA — resource cost · timesheet approval chains · rate cards	multiple	Adding cost to resources · Timesheet approval chains · Reference rate cards

Hiring, performance and engagement

SCREEN	SHOTS	ARTICLE
Review cycle setup — the single richest article found	20	Setting up employee reviews — Advance Setup
Calibration — bell curve, 9-box, calibrator panel, rating modal	yes	Calibration — bell curve and 9-box grid
Requisition approval workflow · hiring flow builder	4 · 4	Requisition approval · Hiring flow
Career site builder · JD templates · offer templates	4 · 4 · 4	Career site · JD templates · Offer templates
Naukri · LinkedIn · Indeed · Monster USA integrations	3 · 3 · yes · 2	Naukri · LinkedIn · Indeed
Chrome sourcing extension · scorecards · candidate profile score	4 · yes · yes	Chrome extension · Scorecards · Profile score
AI interview questions · AI feedback summaries	3 · 2	AI interview questions · AI feedback summaries
1:1 meetings · PIP module · growth plans · skills	3 · yes · yes · yes	1:1 meetings · PIP · Skills
Pulse analytics and heat maps · surveys · polls · announcements	yes	Pulse data · Surveys · Polls
Award programs — nominees, certificate customiser, winners	yes	Award programs

Video walkthroughs of live screens

Keka's Video Academy contains screen recordings rather than static shots — often the fastest way to see a workflow end to end. Notable ones: creating and assigning shifts, the shift scheduler, work-from-home configuration, leave approval chains, leave types, and accepting an offer letter as a candidate.

PART 23

Sources

The primary entry points. Part 22 carries the screenshot-bearing article links; this is the set of root sources the report was built from.

Keka's own properties

Admin Help Centre

help.keka.com/hc/en-us/categories/38988972316305-Admin-Help-Center

Developer portal

— API reference, authentication, rate limits, scopes, webhooks, App Portal, partner guides
developers.keka.com

Status page

— the source for the regional shard topology and incident history
status.keka.com

Pricing page

— tier feature lists, FAQ on setup fee, lock-in and refunds (prices are JS-rendered and not in the source)
keka.com/pricing

Service level agreements

— the three support plan tiers
keka.com/service-level-agreement

Security page and Data Protection Addendum

— certifications, RPO/RTO, encryption, retention, breach notification
keka.com/security

Customer onboarding

— the published seven-step implementation process
keka.com/customer-onboarding

Support page

— channels, hours, the 30-minute phone cap
keka.com/support

Marketplace

— the integration catalogue
keka.com/marketplace

Regional sites

— US and UAE payroll, pricing and SLA

keka.com/us

.

keka.com/ae/payroll-processing

Legacy help index

— often richer article bodies; partly robots-blocked

help.keka.com/admin/payroll

.

help.keka.com/admin/leave-attendance

Freshdesk archive

— older articles, useful when the newer host is blocked

support.keka.com

.

keka.freshdesk.com

Third-party — pricing and listings

SaaSworthy

— the most granular pricing source; India tiers plus Keka Hire per-recruiter rates. Updated 25 Mar 2025

saasworthy.com/product/keka/pricing

Techjockey (India and US)

— India base prices ex-tax; US per-employee pricing with US-specific feature lists

techjockey.com/detail/keka-hris

.

techjockey.com/us/detail/keka-hris

SelectSoftware Reviews

— US pricing, implementation fees, add-on list. Published 27 Jan 2026

selectsoftwarereviews.com/reviews/keka

hr.software

— most recent listing (15 Sep 2026); the only source for the Keka Learn price

hr.software/reviews/keka

TechnologyCounter

— corroborates India base prices

technologycounter.com/products/keka-hr

CrazeHQ

— the best historical record of the 2024 price list. 25 May 2024

crazehq.com/blog/keka-review

Third-party — reviews and market data

G2

— 4.4/5 across 2,391 reviews; all sub-scores, mention counts, segment mix, and the aggregated time-to-implement figure
g2.com/products/keka

Gartner Digital Markets pool

— Capterra, GetApp and Software Advice share one 91-review pool; the 3.9/5 customer-service score
capterra.com/p/149253/Keka

Gartner Peer Insights

— 4.6/5 from 69 ratings; the "Cloud HCM Suites for Regional and/or Sub-1,000 Employee Enterprises" categorisation
gartner.com – Peer Insights

TrustRadius • SoftwareSuggest • Techjockey

— 6.9/10, 4.7/5 and 4.4/5 respectively; the outliers in both directions
ustradius.com/products/keka
 .
softwaresuggest.com/keka

Google Play and Apple App Store

— 4.7/5 from 37.1K and 7.1K ratings; version, size and OS requirements
play.google.com – Keka HR

MCA registry via TheCompanyCheck

— incorporation date, CIN, registered office, headcount, FY25 revenue. The authoritative source on company facts
thecompanycheck.com – Keka Technologies Pvt Ltd

Entrackr and Inc42

— FY23 and FY24 financials, funding history, leadership
entrackr.com
 .
inc42.com

Competitor pricing — taken from each vendor's own page**greyTHR**

greythr.com/pricing

Zoho Payroll (India) and Zoho People

zoho.com/in/payroll/pricing

HROne

— also the most prolific publisher of adversarial Keka content; its core price list matches neutral sources, its unique claims do not
hrone.cloud/pricing

sumHR

sumhr.com/pricing-signup

SOURCES DELIBERATELY EXCLUDED

ITQlick (auto-generated; invents an "Enterprise" tier and \$49/\$99/\$499 prices, and contradicts Keka's own FAQ on both the trial and the setup fee). **The Capterra / Software Advice "Basic — \$20.00 per user per month" record** (stale; Keka has no "Basic" plan). **SelectHub's "\$115.72"** and **SoftwareSuggest's USD figures** (both are FX conversions of the India rupee price presented as dollar pricing). **GetApp UAE's \$96/\$137/\$192** (the 2024 India prices converted at ≈₹73/USD). And a cluster of AI-generated affiliate sites carrying mutually contradictory numbers.

Compiled 18 September 2026 from Keka's own help centre, developer documentation, legal agreements, status page and marketing site, together with independent review platforms, the MCA registry and Indian business press. Roughly 900 source URLs were consulted across six parallel research streams.

Diagrams are original schematics drawn from documented behaviour, not screen captures — see Part 22 for Keka's own screenshot-bearing articles. Prices are third-party sourced because Keka publishes none in its page source; verify any figure before relying on it commercially. Where sources conflicted, the conflict is shown rather than resolved silently. Nothing here is an endorsement or a recommendation to buy.